

Speaker1: [00:00:02] Hum.

Speaker2: [00:00:04] Ok, I understand. Sorry. It asks me. The meeting is recorded. I acknowledge that I understand because it's like an agreement. Otherwise, they absolutely don't want it.

Speaker1: [00:00:14] Hum. How would you like us to refer to your partner, girlfriend, spouse, companion? Do you have a preferred term?

Speaker2: [00:00:26] Well, I like to say my wife actually.

Speaker1: [00:00:28] Your wife, very well. How long have you been with your wife?

Speaker2: [00:00:34] It's going to be [1-5] years soon. Ok.

Speaker1: [00:00:38] Listen, first of all, I would like you to tell me about the love story you're currently experiencing with your wife.

Speaker2: [00:00:46] Well. First, uh, we met and uh well, on a dating site for fun. Hum. It was just to meet people, sleep with them, not on a conveyor belt, but a bit like that and. And then [Partner's Name] actually. I told myself, well, I won't let her go. Because she's pure. And since the reason I was on a fun dating site was that I no longer believed in the ability to truly love. What we call the Little Prince syndrome, which is not a real syndrome but the Little Prince at the end, gets bitten by the snake to save the rose and the traveler. There you go. It was, but really, really not for oneself, etc. For the other and but the other and their desire. And for the other to become the man or woman of their life and for it to be the same on both sides. So I had a hard time finding that and so I told myself yes, but since I always love more than the other loves me, at some point you get tired. So there you go. And then when I met [Partner's Name], uh, we talked a lot, I read her texts, I read her very, very naive paintings because I come from an artistic background where no one would have dared to publish such things. And this naive side but not naive as people wrongly attribute to this word. Actually, naive means just to believe.

Speaker2: [00:02:36] Uh believe in what you're doing, believe simply and not be afraid and not be ashamed. In that sense, and. And I found that very beautiful because the paintings reflect a lot of things. The drawings on the other, even more so with writing, it's sure. And there was no. No pretense, no legends. I always deliver a little bit. It imitates a little bit someone or there's a bit of an exhibition. There, there was none. So, indeed, these things touched me a lot and I told myself meeting someone pure. Finally, yes, that's it, in a way it's rare. So I said I'll keep her around. Finally, I mean, I'll make her a friend actually. But in the end, we stayed. I stayed [1-5] days with her and after that, we never left each other. Then everyday life was very, very complicated. Already because we don't live at all in the same place. We live [6-10] kilometers apart, so we just do round trips. And also because I always lived with a boy. And you're a boy. You'll find that I'm very bad. So for me, a boy's only goal in life is to succeed in life. It's to make his wife and children happy and the woman in return. For me, she is the perfect woman. In fact, she will do everything in return and so it makes an exchange like that, quite natural.

Speaker2: [00:04:23] And so, when you are a mother with a child, the boy presents himself as the ideal stepfather and so normally. From all my experiences. He will, for me to be fully invested, be extraordinary with my children. But then he will really get involved, he will really, really do his best and say a horrible thing I can't, you're a boy. But so, they know that if a mother has children, which is very different from a couple who doesn't have children. But they know very well how it goes, that if the children don't accept, it will generally cause problems. Especially since from the moment a mother has children, she looks for a stepfather and she doesn't necessarily look for just a husband. But there with [Partner's Name], who is a mother, so a woman. And so, yes, it caused problems because I couldn't. The criteria, the functions, all that were quite. Different. Uh. Because she expected the same thing from my side. As a woman. Uh, as a feminine woman, to simplify, these are two feminine women who are together. So it's complicated because the masculine woman takes the same criteria, so she wants to satisfy her partner like that and she proves even more that she's more skilled than a man and blah blah blah in the lesbian level.

Speaker2: [00:06:01] So there you go. But there, it's two feminine women together, two mothers. With experiences, lives that are couples with boys. Even if she had a girlfriend, it was a bit of a disaster so she can't refer to it and so it causes problems because I had to change my way of seeing things a lot. My way of thinking. Just like for a boy, I explain that it's the same. Just because we're girls and among girls, when we talk, we guess each other's needs very easily, we women do, but we only do it at the level of our children and our friends. As soon as it affects in a couple, everything becomes more crazy, more complicated and that is universal. So if she really wants something, she has to tell me clearly. Exactly what we ask of a boy. It has to be clear, it has to be expressed really. Here, I want us to absolutely go see the fireworks. There's a fireworks display tonight. There you go. It's clear. But if I am supposed to have understood that she wanted to see the fireworks and in the meantime, yes, but with some perhaps things, so for me it's not clear and. And then she goes to bed because she's tired. Well, I say to myself, well, she's asleep, I'll call a friend.

Speaker2: [00:07:41] And well, it's not clear because then when I go to bed, she'll tell me, well, I absolutely wanted to see the fireworks, you don't care! Uh. You can go. Since we didn't talk about it again. I said to myself, well, she's tired, let's move on. It's because it wasn't clear. And so, even when we're girls, in an intimate relationship, we're still the same. That is to say, if it's not clear, if it's not affirmed as a decision like tonight we go out at [Time], the fireworks are there. There you go. If it's not clear as I would say tonight we will be on time, [Time], we go there. Does it tempt you? Yes? No? There you go. And if it's just she should understand, etc. We have exactly the same problem as in a heterosexual couple where the woman thinks the man will understand and everything like that. But it's false. It has to be, it's the same, that's a lie. Because a man is the same, if he thinks she understood that he was tired and well no, as long as he hasn't expressed it clearly the woman, although she says she has a sixth sense, it's false. As long as it's not clear, it's not clear. So it was a bit more complicated there and and I find myself with communication difficulties that I never encountered with a boy.

Speaker1: [00:09:14] Yes no, I'm listening. You were about to say.

Speaker2: [00:09:17] There you go and there you go, communication problems. I had never encountered a boy with a boy. Is it related to her personality and character and personal history or is it because we're two girls? Without labels, without. Calling ourselves feminine or masculine, that is to say without. There you go, without a specific role. And so, I find that quite complicated. For this story of guessing and implications. What we call romanticism too, that the other should want to please the other and should guess their desires and should respond to them. Uh well, actually it doesn't work. That doesn't work at all because as soon as it affects, we misunderstand. We misunderstand the other's needs. Precisely because it is too close to us, we don't understand it well and so it causes communication problems. Uh. So yes, it's a bit complicated, so it takes time. It means discussing and discussing again and again. Uh. That's all actually. That's a bit more complicated. Uh. After me, personally, I am dyslexic and I have attention deficit disorder and I am suspected of being autistic Asperger's. Uh. And so, I also have a different neuronal functioning so. So I also have to explain my reactions. Uh. Uh there you go, which are not necessarily those expected for example.

Speaker2: [00:11:42] And since all my children are dyslexic. My friends are either gifted or dyslexic or dys, all mixed up or autistic Asperger's. So we all have a Symbian neuronal system. So all the questions we ask ourselves, we, I had never asked myself before because even my former partner was autistic Asperger's. Uh. So I think that also must play on this communication and the fact that let's say the man-woman role is. Even if everyone complains, it's quite clear anyway. Hum. Quite clear. After that, we agree or not, but more or less, it's clear. And I realized it was very annoying a woman. Compared to all these little things of. Of having to guess the other's expectation because it is obvious. He he he well no! Actually, it doesn't work in all couples in the world, it doesn't work, it exists with old couples who have been there for generations, the old there, the old grandma and grandpa who have been living together for [40-45] years, who know that if the man makes a face like that, it's because he didn't have enough biscuits, it's [Day]. He wanted his croissant and if she does the dishes four times it's because she's not well. But that's still a matter of time, of knowledge of the other but that takes time to see these little.

Speaker2: [00:13:26] There you go, we have that, we have the distance. After that, it's the first person I want to live with in the same house, so it's still because I trust because it's still not an easy decision when you have children. Uh. And that you don't want to put these children in a fragile or dangerous situation or end up on the street, it's no. Alone sometimes we can take risks. Well, we don't care a bit, we always find a solution, we only blame ourselves and on that. And then on us. Uh. The things that could come back. It would be uh money, which is a big factor of misunderstandings or things like that. Uh, it took a long time before I really saw my partner's accounts. Really? And then I said, oh yes, now we're going to do something. Uh and then also the fact that we want, yes, I want us to live together because we both have small incomes and I'm sure it will be much simpler. There you go. Uh. Because I realized that it was a long-distance relationship. We call it that, but it costs a lot in gasoline for the round trips, the last-minute shopping, the quick meals because we don't have time to cook between two things.

Speaker2: [00:15:11] Uh it's [Name], things like that. So it goes very, very quickly financially and and we are not settled to make thoughtful purchases. We are in urgency, the fact of doing that,

so that's not good. And then it doesn't suit me at all, who am a routine person necessarily. And uh. After that, there's sexuality too. It's quite complicated, well it was complicated when at the beginning, when I was with [Partner's Name], I was in an open relationship. And then she realized a feeling she had never felt before, jealousy. So she wanted to change. And. Q How is our couple style called? Enclosed together. And that didn't suit me. Because then I was the one who was jealous in that situation where I was uncomfortable and so it caused a chill, it made it, it made too many breaks and it caused a blockage and. On my basic functioning that is changing. As the human nature can gradually fix childhood traumas and manage to. Let's say I was raped and abused a lot, so I like to dominate necessarily, even though most of the time I am dominant.

Speaker2: [00:16:50] It's that I don't like being fragile. But. But then. But then yes, by working on oneself and everything, indeed the couple relationship, I manage to consider it differently. So before I could only project myself into the other's desire. Very. Lacanian actually. I love the other's desire and like a stencil, I will. Uh, Abandon myself. In the other's desire. But if she works exactly the same way as me. So it caused a problem too in terms of profile. It's like if you have two dominant boys together. As they will tell you well we can't, even if we love each other, we can't live together. So there you go, it's the same thing. And so that, that was complicated then. And then we wanted to take time for ourselves and with the round trips, the children, it was complicated and she had flare-ups of yes, we were not destined together, flare-ups of what we call uh violent inflammatory crises. Very, very violent. Caution 23 Burning And she, she has. Psoriatic arthritis. Which is an inflammatory disease that destroys tendons and muscles. And this inflammation, it's excruciating pain. There are no real treatments that are suitable.

Speaker2: [00:18:27] And so, it was very, very difficult because I couldn't touch her, she hurt everywhere, all the time. Uh it was complicated. It was complicated. Especially since when you hurt but to this extent, you won't explain. Well, when you're tired or when you hurt, I mean you have less patience, but. You will pay less attention to what the other will feel when you speak. And you will be more likely. To get anxious, to get angry. So it caused problems like yes, I have no more cotton swabs, really crappy, but really ridiculous. So that, that was very, very difficult this period actually, her inflammatory crisis, it was after the Corona vaccine. There were several in addition. And that caused inflammatory crises. Hum. It was very annoying. So she had surgery. She has a total knee replacement, so it was very hard because it was a moment of support, even if it wasn't easy first shoulder and then second shoulder. So every time we can't cut, we can't eat, we can't dress, well you see. So now she has a lot less pain, she has a lot of pain. A lot, but not less. Nobody realizes. So now it's okay. But it was a big, big personal journey and.

Speaker2: [00:20:13] The most complicated. It was that since she complained a lot. Well, I don't complain anymore. Yes, the situation doesn't suit me and there, I couldn't do it anymore because she was doing it in my place. So, I found myself with my double in front and it made me think a lot about how I could have been before. I must have been very annoying and I realize it now actually. And it didn't hurt to find myself in front of myself somewhere unintentionally. And so that, that made me think a lot. And. There you go. And. Now, we're at the stage where. We want to get an apartment together. But this decision took time. One

wouldn't think because she wanted it more at the beginning but not me. I had a lot of things to sort out. With myself. I always dreamed of having a council flat with three bedrooms for [Amount]. That way, I tell myself anything can happen to me, perfect, I can host everyone at Christmas. And so. It took me time to. Make choices, so choices are mournings. She also on her side has to make choices, so mournings, because she likes her apartment anyway, to come to terms with not being in the same town as me, it's.

Speaker2: [00:21:55] To go further. Actually, we humans would like to have it all. And actually, we can't. We try to make choices and each choice involves renunciations or mournings, we can't have it all. Not possible. So that's where we are. And uh. Because we didn't really have the opportunity to really live together. Hum. I don't know how to say it. The fact. These round trips, actually, it's. I had friends who had their apartment, but they spent 80% of the time at my place. But no. These [1-5] days, it's not the same actually. And at the beginning it worried me a lot and now us. Because we had a lot, a lot of discussions actually. About the fact that I like to be in a couple but that I need alone time. Where I am not available to write. I am next to, but I respond finally, I don't necessarily want to talk for [1-5] hours. And or I will write, or I will have to or think. There you go, simply. And it's not because I get up in the morning, I take my coffee and I am writing. I mustn't forget my dream, for example, that the other, I'm sulking them. But it's just that. I think it's more a matter of knowing the other or I don't know an idea.

Speaker2: [00:23:42] And [Partner's Name] is someone who needs a lot of attention to be reassured. Yes. Uh. While I have always lived as much with my children as with the people I was with as roommates. Each has their space, each is in motion and I think the only meeting point is the evening meal. Yes. So there you go. But it's normal because she doesn't live with us. So when I am at her place, it's like I belong to her. It's not all the time, you see. So there you go, that's why. But I am ready now. We want to live together. But yes, there is still a lot of communication work. Trying to understand each other. It's not. It's not that easy actually. And even when we think we're clear, we're not necessarily. And the other thinks they're clear, they're not necessarily. Me, if I'm told we should buy bread, I leave right away to the bakery. Hum! While it's in the week, we should get some. If I'm not told in the week, we should. We should think about buying bread. Well I will take action right away. There you go, it's said. I think it's more a matter of communication actually. There you go.

Speaker1: [00:25:21] But a story what. I'm listening, I'm listening.

Speaker2: [00:25:25] Even if I never encountered that with a boy. Because. Because. Because I did. They followed me actually. They had their thing too. But I mean, we were in herd mode. Well, no individuality. Finally, it was more. Each had a great idea to please the children or me or. So I had never asked myself the question in the other sense. So. And until now, people were. Very happy to be in our family which is a family with a lot of love, a lot of recognition. We are people who love children a lot. They love people a lot, they give a lot, they laugh a lot, they love doing activities, activities, they propose things, they are always in a good mood. So before, I had never asked myself all these questions.

Speaker1: [00:26:34] I said. Asked the question in the other sense.

Speaker2: [00:26:40] Uh. Yes, as soon as the other has needs and. Realizing that I wasn't enough on my own for the other's happiness. Hum. And that it's not just. They are with me so the person is happy and that's it. And they need something else. So that was very hard on a narcissistic level let's say. Somehow, it was very difficult because it hadn't happened before. That. And that I wasn't enough. To make the other happy. And so I couldn't on my own make the other happy. And that was very frustrating. Because it's a situation that hadn't happened to me and. Or that I hadn't realized because I wasn't interested or whatever. And then people give you a bit what you want to hear too. But so I hadn't had that. And for example, [Partner's Name] needs to see her family because I have mine and. To see her family, to see her friends. But she needs me for that. Hum. She needs me to come with her. While I don't work like that. That is to say, I go see my friends alone. Hum. Because it's an intimate moment where the other will tell you their intimacy? You will tell yours. Uh. And I don't necessarily need to share it and. And so yes, it's after. It's more a matter of starting, of shyness to go to places she's afraid to go and then she goes alone. But and then I hate going out too, I hate that, it scares me.

Speaker2: [00:28:47] It's something I don't like. I do it to please in general, for my children, for my partner. But it's not something where I take pleasure, me. Since the chameleon. So there you go, it's the role expected of me, but that's all. So it doesn't please me actually. While I dance, I sing, I do everything people want me to do, but. And actually it's not at all something I like. And uh. But it pleases me to see that others are happy. Hum there you go, in that sense. But yes, knowing that. We can't in a couple just. Us alone, we are not enough. To make the other happy. That the other's happiness doesn't depend only on the fact that they are with us. Well, that's very very very very frustrating. It's very. I think I must not be the only one to think that to believe that some think that the other can be. We are not. When we return. And I, it was that. To welcome someone into our homeland. Having been selected, if you see what I mean somehow. Uh is a chance and that they are happy. Well, the fact that it's not the case. It was very hard. Now that I realize it was a bit special anyway. But since it revealed itself in my life with boys so.

Speaker2: [00:30:56] So there you go, that's complicated. I never answered questions about things, I don't know much, but there you go.

Speaker1: [00:31:01] You. You said you realized that indeed. The mere fact of being there, being yourself, being in the relationship, integrating her into your herd, as you said, could not, might not be enough and that other things were needed. I would like you to talk to me about these other things.

Speaker2: [00:31:16] Well her children are far. Hum, uh. Not very long ago, they were still present, but now they are [26-30] years old. And [30-35] years old. One is in [City]. And a daughter. Then in [City]. And they were separated for a while. And it's true that. She who is very family-oriented and all, she sees them very little and for her, it's very difficult to be far from her children. I have mine with me all the time actually. And. And so, that makes her sad. Even sleeping with that actually. So that makes her sad because she misses her children and. And so we will have to go in [Month] to her sister's. I don't want to at all. They are nice, huh, I don't want to at all because she will be able to see her sister and her children, it's closer, it's the north of

[Country] all that. She will be able to see them. And yes, she would like me to come with her because it's [6-10] hours round trip because despite appearances, she is quite shy anyway. So it gives courage when someone comes with you because these are subjects that touch on fragile topics anyway, the emotions that can be overwhelming when a child is missing and all that. Her children are very modest compared to mine for example.

Speaker2: [00:32:53] But they are a bit like [Partner's Name], she doesn't express her emotions in a very tactile way, very uh. There you go. While we do stuff, whatever, we laugh all the time and all. There you go. And so. So, I have to go. Yeah but I don't want to. Because for me, it's hell to go see people all that. I hate that. But I know that there you go. And so yes, she misses her children. She misses her family because when her father died, the whole family broke up just before our meeting. When she separated from her first partner, her first partner, she left with all her friends. She turned them against her. It was very hard. I was there all along to untangle all that. And so she found herself with a herd of friends for years and lots of things together with nothing. Then [redacted]. Difficult and. She had the life of a woman in a couple who doesn't have children because her children are grown, who had a lot of time for themselves, while I didn't. I know that afterwards I will have this void and that I will necessarily fill it by not having friends. It's. But I realized that yes, the fact of being. That she was sad. That hurt me a lot. She was sad despite the fact that we were together. That was complicated.

Speaker1: [00:34:34] I understand well what you are telling me. You realized in fact that your presence, your support and the love you could give her was not enough and that she needed external support and presence as well. Yeah.

Speaker2: [00:34:46] And so, for me it was difficult actually. Because until then, people were symbiotic with me. How do you call it? Yeah, and it's usually me who would reconnect the links with their children, create ideal conditions for them to come. But it didn't come from. From the other while she, it comes from her actually. And so, I am not used to this. Never dated a woman who is a mother too, normal. And so, we are two people with the same needs, the same concerns. She, she would like her herd actually.

Speaker1: [00:35:29] But why do you think there is this difference? You just mentioned that you resemble each other, but why? Why in your previous relationship you were enough and why not in this one?

Speaker2: [00:35:41] I don't know. My [name], he completely abandoned his children. He was with mine and with me as he had never been with all his women and his children. Hum. [Name]. He was a big psychological problem. He was violent so it doesn't count. But however, he was very kind to my children. He was about everything I asked for, except when he went crazy. Uh. And he cried a lot because. He wanted to offer me lots of things that I didn't have and I learned later. I understood later that all the things I got for cheap. Actually, it was because he had negotiated everything in my place before. Uh [Name], he has a son, a daughter he never wants to see again, a son he sees from time to time. But. No, no, he became the father of my children actually. He devoted himself entirely each time and devoted himself. A. So. But why? I don't know. The difference. Because he was alone. Maybe he finally had no more family, or little. Or

when the stepfather sees your child once during the summer holidays, you are still alone 90% of the time.

Speaker2: [00:37:23] You don't make the important decisions. After the kids are teens, so after they have their girlfriends, they don't need you except for money every month for outings. But there you go. Finally necessarily. And so, yeah, I think it's because maybe they needed it. While she, she already has her family. Finally. Links. She misses her children. Yeah. I don't know, I think with my head but uh how I see things? But I don't know. But there you go. And then there are lots of people. She is part of people who like to go out, who like to have friends. Uh. And I have my friends, that's for sure, but I am not. I was on the phone, that's enough for me actually. I don't necessarily need all the time. After I have [1-5] children. That fills me up inside a lot. I am not empty actually, I have [1-5] children on a daily basis, even if the eldest is in [City]. I call him, we send each other bread, I am full. Actually, I don't know. I don't entirely feel empty. Actually, I don't know how to say. The day I know my daughter was gone, my son was not there.

Speaker2: [00:39:01] And at school boarding. My daughter was gone to her friend's and he wasn't there. Well, it's true that I was downright depressed. That is to say, what to do? To cook, for whom? For what? I didn't even do the dishes. Oh yes, I wasn't well. Because to everyone I said yes, I was often alone. But no, I am not alone. If I have my children. It's false. Actually, it's a lie that I wasn't aware of. But actually, as long as we have children, we are not alone. There's the couple. Who, who? Who makes you strong too. In this unconditional love, when it's of this nature and is to the child. And you take care of the other. You take care of someone, you worry about someone and this person does the same for you. So you don't feel alone. And she, she doesn't have her children with her. So she is more fragile than me and I realized that when I found myself alone at home, where I was much worse than her finally. Much more sensitive, much more fragile.

Speaker1: [00:40:18] If I understand well, what was hard for you is realizing that the inherent emptiness to everyone could not only be filled for [Partner's Name] with the relationship you had. Yes.

Speaker2: [00:40:32] But because I hadn't simply realized it uh and uh. That's all. It was complicated, but actually I tell myself it's logical because if I don't have my children with me because I have [1-5] at home currently, I know that. It might not be enough for me either. I would need friendly relationships, intelligent intellectual food. But I mean, maybe, yes, being able to have. I don't know actually. I know that being alone, yes, I felt very fragile.

Speaker1: [00:41:16] You talked earlier about social norms, notably about the expectation we can have in heterosexual relationships between a woman and a man regarding the roles attributed to men and the roles attributed to women and that there were adaptation difficulties. For you and [Partner's Name], when you got together. Because precisely, these social norms, these roles and these expectations found themselves a bit redistributed, reshuffled, reorganized and you had to find a new organization.

Speaker2: [00:41:45] That's it?

Speaker1: [00:41:48] What. I would like you to talk to me about the difference precisely between these heterosexual couples and and homosexual lesbian in this case.

Speaker2: [00:41:59] Actually, we say that none. When you have a feminine and masculine together, it's exactly like the same. A straight couple, there's no problem, it's exactly the same. The masculine girl will work, she will make the little dishes, she will treat her like a princess and she, she will look for the woman who will best take care of her. Secure her, pamper her, take care of her. If she doesn't take enough care of her, she will go to another. Like in straight couples and. There, there's no. It's when it's, there's not really. Well, [Partner's Name] and I. People still think that [Partner's Name] is the more masculine one but it's physical actually, it's not necessarily. It's the image we can give physically, but not mentally. Hum, you see femininity on the masculine side, it's a brain function, it has nothing to do with the way we dress and. And so with her ex. She had, she had a woman's relationship. Finally, she had left the guy. Actually. If you want to be her girlfriend, she did the gardening and DIY, you see? Uh. And and there, no, there's no. It's like two feminine together actually.

Speaker1: [00:43:35] He almost had to. Sorry, I interrupted you.

Speaker2: [00:43:39] Well, he had to that I am not in a girl's place, that is to say waiting to be satisfied and complaining when it doesn't suit me.

Speaker1: [00:43:46] So he had to, if I understand well, reassign, re-attribute roles. Yes, it wasn't obvious.

Speaker2: [00:43:53] For me, it was complicated.

Speaker1: [00:43:55] And then? How did you do to reassign these roles, re-choose these roles? Did you choose stereotyped roles or did you take certain things that suited you better?

Speaker2: [00:44:07] No, no, actually, we are in the couple, but there it's -1 relation to the couple that there are still issues. Uh. It's what we call. It's called these couples. It's the balanced couple relationship. I have trouble with that, me. Uh. I have a lot of trouble living a balanced couple relationship. Where we are equal, equal men. Where each has the same needs, the same expectations, etc. But it's not that easy this system. It's what I do with [Partner's Name] and. What I started to do with [Name], my ex? Because uh, he is very feminine anyway. Not physically, huh. Physically, he is a very manly man. Hum. But uh. Since he is a partisan of gender equality at 100%. And who says we men are women like the others, We too want to be understood, etc., etc. So uh. So I had started with him, but I haven't finished being healed, let's say. And uh. But I continue with [Partner's Name]. And there [Partner's Name], it's at high speed anyway huh, because there it's really. My [Name]. His only goal in life was to make his wife and children happy. Happiness was simple. It was the peaceful life, happiness. Everyone is happy, everyone is fulfilled. There you go. So.

Speaker1: [00:46:07] That's not the case with [Partner's Name]. No.

Speaker2: [00:46:12] It's complicated. And.

Speaker1: [00:46:18] So what is it?

Speaker2: [00:46:21] Because it's more complicated.

Speaker1: [00:46:23] Yes. What is [Partner's Name] looking for then? It's not what you describe.

Speaker2: [00:46:27] She needs. I lived exactly in the phase where she was. With my ex-husband. The first, well, the only one I married, who was [30-35] years older than me. Uh. It looks more like a love of a father unconditional. And he was the. He was as much the father of my children as mine. Finally, it was really the unconditional. It's really. Uh. There you go. So, uh. I had crises, I had fugues, I did everything I didn't do when I was young. Hum hum. So he helped me enormously. Opened. It's the only time I loved myself. It's the only time everything actually. My sexuality started there actually. Very late actually, because I needed to feel loved for man. And well, he died, necessarily, but it was very, very difficult and unconsciously, I always look for a. A relationship. So I know I have to work that no. [Name] says But you! You always have the princess role, but it's not that. But it's true that I need when I need to be respected as something fragile here and there. But then in return, I give a lot a lot because I take a lot of risks, I do, I do everything. After, I mean, I really do everything, I give everything, but. But it's true that I need to feel reassured. So that's quite common to the feminine gender. Well, basically huh, not to all and. And so. And then what was the question? But. Ah yes, yes, that's it actually. Yes, I had the princess thing anyway.

Speaker1: [00:48:40] You said that this relationship is Sorry? I interrupted you. No, I'm listening.

Speaker2: [00:48:45] On which I try to work. Not as if because I haven't found. Enough to work on that. The last, the last one I saw, it wasn't great, but. But on that actually working on that.

Speaker1: [00:49:03] You said that this relationship with this person who was both your father and your and your husband and the husband of your children, it was the only time you felt loved.

Speaker2: [00:49:15] Yeah. At [30-35].

Speaker1: [00:49:20] No, it's something that never happened again.

Speaker2: [00:49:24] Uh, If I felt loved by [Name]? By [Partner's Name]. But if you want. He wasn't expressive enough. But so, I feel it, I see well that all she took enormous risks for me, put her life in danger. Physically, morally. It's just that she is less expressive, so I didn't realize. We realized later but. Well let's say I. [Partner's Name] will talk to me about her needs.

Speaker1: [00:50:09] Also, if I understand what you tell me, it's that you describe actually a more encompassing love in this relationship which is both a relationship of a father and at the same time a relationship of a spouse, at the same time a relationship.

Speaker2: [00:50:22] Well yes because look, a father. Basically, he has an unconditional relationship. There you go so his goal. It's for you to be happy or fulfilled, that you grow, etc., etc. So there's a very accompanying side, positive and who will do and do that everything you

say, it will be great, wonderful and he will accompany you through all the stages of your life, whatever they are actually, and she will do exactly the same for your children wrapped in softness all the time, tenderness, attention. So indeed, I know that it no longer exists, it doesn't exist. Already because I am old before uh a mentor actually. So hum. So actually, it's really the thing you do when you are very, very young and you have fun at the same time. So it's more complicated as a relationship. It's not a normal relationship anyway, because it's all one-sided. Yes. I know it's not balanced.

Speaker1: [00:51:45] That's why you also talked about the fact that you have trouble with balanced relationships.

Speaker2: [00:51:52] Yes, but I know a real relationship is a balanced relationship.

Speaker1: [00:51:56] A real relationship is a balanced relationship. Yes.

Speaker2: [00:52:04] So no. Yes, in a general sense, but otherwise no. It's a submissive, non-submissive or a submissive? No. No because he no, no but no. Because his desire is turned towards the need to please the other. And it allows him to forget himself so. No but. Yes, I know I have to work on that, on the. The couple. Who says true?

Speaker1: [00:52:49] You tell me about love. Sorry, I interrupted you.

Speaker2: [00:52:52] Yes, more. That it be equal actually. But. I know, I work anyway. I am moving forward huh? But if ever there's a feeling or a word of dissatisfaction, I get stuck. Yeah yeah but well. Anyway, I have to learn that I continue to move forward. Because I know where it comes from, me? My father treated me like God made man. Until I was [1-5] years old. After his mother died, he had a depression he never got out of and he never took care of me or my brother again. And so unconsciously, you look for that thing, that bottomless void actually. Uh. So yes, I have people I like a lot, who are a bit older people you appreciate, who are a bit mentors, whether in professional or other environments. You find that a bit anyway. After my, my, my partners, my partners. Always had at least [11-15] years older than me anyway. So. I am aware that I also look for protection. Yeah.

Speaker1: [00:54:28] You tell me. You tell me about love, you tell me about different kinds of love. The love of an encompassing mentor, the love one can give to their partner, their companion. I would like you to tell me about what love is for you based on your experience.

Speaker2: [00:54:50] Uh. Love is the true for me. True love is actually. Loving the other for what they are, as they are. And wanting the other to be happy. And if we are not the person. Or if we can be a hindrance, we must leave. That's true love. It's loving the other as they are for what they are and wanting the other to become the man or woman of their life.

Speaker1: [00:55:28] Of their own life. Yes.

Speaker2: [00:55:30] That's it, loving someone. The only difference between a sexual love is the sexual relationship, even if consequently there are feelings that can be jealousy, things like that

that can be a bit. Hindering finally. A that can impact this pure side a bit. But when we love someone, we want the other to be happy normally and we want them to grow. We want them to flourish, we want them to be at the maximum of their potential. They can give. And somewhere, we want the same in return. Uh. That is to say that. Feeling that it is sincere, that it is true and that it denies. What has always marked me is my vision of love, it's that. That's my true vision of love. And what has always marked me is that for example, you have a friend or a girlfriend. Who goes to a bar to drink alcohol and put themselves in danger. If you're friends. You arrive, you take your girlfriend or your friend and you take them with you. You slap them three times in the face, you put your fingers in their mouth, you make them vomit, you pour buckets of water and you will save them actually. Whether the girl gets assaulted by other girls or other by guys, or the guy does nonsense he regrets all his life. Whatever, You want to be his friend, you will help him actually. But if it's your partner. Why will you get angry? Why will you leave crying? Why are you disappointed? It's not a continuity of yourself, it's a separate being.

Speaker2: [00:57:06] Who has as much and so it's that which is complicated, I think. In love currently. Actually, we take the other too much for a continuity of ourselves and it's false. The other is the other and they are different from you. The only common point is the vase we make together. The common us, but it's what we build, it's not the person. So yes, there are things we will accept from our friends but not from our partner. Man. We will console our friend for something a girlfriend will say Yeah. Honestly, this dress looks great on you, it highlights you and all, but if it's your wife wearing it, well you will find it vulgar and all while it's the same thing. And I think the problem is that. It's the affect actually that relates to oneself, the image people will think. Yeah, I think that's it actually, it's the image people will think. It's not even you thinking Yeah but what will people say? If my wife drinks or if my guy drinks while. You personally, you don't care they drink and have a drink with their friends. You're happy for them and all, but no, it's the other. What will they think? Yeah uh. I. How do you call that? It's horrible, huh? I. Yeah, you can't control your man or you can't control your woman. And it's the others actually, it's the family that lowers their eyes. The shame for you and all. It's the weight of society, societal values, the image of success and failure which. Well, the younger generations, we start to escape a bit, but it still weighs actually, it's that you will present your boyfriend or your girlfriend to the family. They are accepted, the girl. It's. I find it weighs a lot on the couple. And it shouldn't, but I think it affects a lot. I still live it, I live it sometimes in my reactions, in my emotions. I say to myself but wait, are you crazy or what? Hum. But yes, I live it. My ex, [Name], who spent time at the bar, I said yeah, frankly, you're annoying, couldn't you go to another bar where we don't see you? Because my mother and my brother pass by and they are sad every time and they worry.

Speaker1: [00:58:52] Why do I find. Excuse me? I interrupted you.

Speaker2: [00:58:56] No, go ahead.

Speaker1: [00:58:58] Finish what you were saying.

Speaker2: [00:59:00] Actually, it's a shame.

Speaker1: [00:59:02] Yes. Why do you think that the gaze of the other, of others, takes so much importance in romantic relationships and less in friendships?

Speaker2: [00:59:14] I think it's the weight of the family.

Speaker1: [00:59:17] The weight of the family.

Speaker2: [00:59:19] I think it's the weight of the family and there's the weight of the social and work environment. Uh. And these two pressures weigh on the individual. [redacted].

Speaker1: [01:00:32] You talked about the fact that others are not us. In a romantic relationship, there are two of us, and the common thing is the relationship itself. Yes, you talked about the fact that.

Speaker2: [01:00:47] Uh.

Speaker1: [01:00:48] We had reactions towards our friends that were not the same towards our partner. Yet, in similar situations, you talked about the fact that the emotion, if I understand correctly, clouds the natural aspect of love that should apply everywhere.

Speaker2: [01:01:13] Imagine you're a woman, I take a guy. A guy. He just lost his mother, you see? Or his sister or his little cousin or I don't know. He's totally miserable. He gets drunk. He climbs on the table, does anything, kisses anyone. And you? If you were his wife or his boyfriend? Uh. You would. You would scold him, slap him, and tell him his bags are at the door. While it's the same miserable guy who needs support. He needs support. First, from the person who is supposed to love him. And just like a friend. Whereas if it was a friend, you. You wouldn't slap him. You'd say [6-10] years, I'm kicking you out. It's complicated, isn't it?

Speaker1: [01:02:05] Why this difference in treatment?

Speaker2: [01:02:07] But that's what I don't know. But I live it too. This influence, I live it, I have already experienced it inside me, this influence.

Speaker1: [01:02:17] Do you think it's something that can be linked to attachment? And the emotions that are specifically involved in romantic relationships.

Speaker2: [01:02:27] Because it's the other, it's others.

Speaker1: [01:02:30] I think it's others.

Speaker2: [01:02:32] Yeah, your guy is hitting on you, kissing another girl. What do you do? What do you do? You come to console him? But are you crazy? You have to make him a jerk. It's others. It's the family that lowers their eyes. Shame for you and all. It's the weight of society, societal values, the image of success and failure. Well, the younger generations are starting to escape it a bit, but it still weighs on the couple. And it shouldn't, but I think it affects a lot. I experience it sometimes in my reactions, in my emotions. I say to myself but wait, are you

crazy? But yes, I live it. My ex, [Name], who spent time at the bar, I said yeah, frankly, you're annoying, couldn't you go to another bar where we don't see him? Because my mother and my brother pass by and they get sad every time and they worry.

Speaker1: [01:03:38] What bothers you is not the fact that he goes to a bar, but that he is seen in that bar.

Speaker2: [01:03:43] Yeah. And I was necessarily uh. A girl who goes out with an alcoholic. Although no. I don't care. I mean, everyone lives their life. I mean, he's not violent, he's not aggressive, he's nice, he doesn't spend his money in the bar, he spends the money he has saved for leisure activities, and he even put [Amount] bucks in our joint account. So I mean no. I didn't even care, you see, it was clear, we each had a part of our income, we had a common fund, we put a percentage, but we removed all our personal expenses. We saw what was left in what was left. We each put [Amount] that we put aside to do what we want and the rest, we put in the common fund. For everyday life stuff, it's quite equal, you see, it's quite clean. So him doing scratch tickets, going for drinks with his friends, or me going to the beautician. Each one does what they want. Alcohol in general can have impacts if the person changes behavior, if they are aggressive, if there are arguments because people get angry, because it can put the family in deficit, things like that. But otherwise. These people are crazy. It's like someone smoking two packs of cigarettes a day. Well yes, we worry a little because well, it can be a concern for their health, but after that it's their business if it doesn't impact the family, if they don't smoke in all the rooms of the house.

Speaker2: [01:05:19] Finally, I don't know. Yes, I know, personal to the other, it's like a contract, a couple. And me, it's others actually. Because I went to see my mother for anything. Oh but you know, we saw [Name] and everything at the [Name] bar. You see, that's actually what it is. Uh. Or you go out with a [occupation]. He's always talking with girls, guys too, but he doesn't tell you. Girls, he's always there and everything. Actually, he's a [occupation]. The [occupation] is 50% seduction, it's his job. People come because they feel listened to, heard, uh as if they were unique, etc. So it's part of the job actually. So it's complicated. It's the weight of what others will think that acts as if the other was a continuation of oneself and reflected what we are. It's like friends actually. I have eclectic friends, but they don't meet each other and they're not compatible with each other. And it's like, you only hang out with rich people, so you were someone good. A bit rotten as an idea, but there you go. Or then, if you hang out with people on welfare or you look for someone who is a punk, uh philosopher on the street, well, you're in the common image, you're uh people have to put you in a category.

Speaker1: [01:06:56] So if I understand correctly, it's the impression that we are being judged ourselves. Actually, what we don't have with friends when it's a romantic relationship.

Speaker2: [01:07:03] Yes, we are judged through the other. For example, if a guy is an artist who doesn't work, a girl is an artist, she doesn't work, okay. But she's not a great artist, huh? There you go. Uh. The other has decent income. He doesn't care. He loves his job and supports her. He loves what she does and all that. And the outside. Not just the family, huh. Well, they will consider that one is being taken advantage of and the other is someone. Supported. There

you go. Plus [1-5] years more. Even more on the level of morality, of the crappy roles we are given. It's a man assisted. It's a man. Uh, what do you call it? Uh yeah, it's a parasite. Or then a girl, we will say the same thing, there you go. And. I think it weighs on the couple. A lot.

Speaker1: [01:08:11] But if I understand what you're saying, it's really this notion that you've developed which is to say that people too often consider the partner as part of themselves and for you, it's like a.

Speaker2: [01:08:25] Reflection, a reflection of the other? Yeah, a continuation or a reflection of the other.

Speaker1: [01:08:30] And for you, it's important to make the distinction precisely to avoid, to try to prevent these reactions we can have in relation to.

Speaker2: [01:08:40] Others who are not of social norms. Yes, it's others.

Speaker1: [01:08:44] And so make a distinction. You talked about it. If I understand what you said, it's also very important for you to accept the other in their entirety, even if they may have behaviors that are markers or behaviors that can be harmful to themselves.

Speaker2: [01:09:02] But if the person does something that is not good for them, well then. Your role will be to try to understand and accompany them. Uh. Why would it be different from the role of a friend? Normally in a couple, a couple in my vision, the other is your woman. Your friend too. It's important that it is a lot your friend anyway. It lasts a long time that friend. And you can have moments where you are their mother and sometimes you are their child. There are moments where we will, uh, support the other, fragile moments, moments where it is the other who will support us. Uh we are all that at the same time and we are lovers, etc. And if there is not all that, if we are only lovers, if it is only fusion, it lacks something. Well it must be really a whole. And the friend side is what will allow it to last, that. So it's important, but it's complicated.

Speaker1: [01:10:12] You talked about the importance of making the other happy and if I understand what you're telling me, for you, in love, there is an important notion of devotion.

Speaker2: [01:10:24] Uh. For me, if we really love, we really love. The other. And. After I'm a bit [Religion] oriented too, it will show. But in [Religion], we each have our path, you see, each one makes their path, we meet people. Who allow. To learn things from each other. Uh. Sometimes to redo the same things several times actually and to say at some point there may be something wrong because I always do the same thing. And so these people only serve to say to themselves well, we always do the same thing, it doesn't suit us. I should think about why and then change, etc. And it is a constant evolution. We are each two individuals and it may be that even if it was wonderful, at some point it separates because we are no longer in the same phase, in the same search. Which does not mean that we hate each other. And we remain two people who live their lives. Even if we have children together. In the past, it might have been more complicated, but today it is not like that. If if there is a woman who who comes. You are both [16-20] years old and all that and you absolutely want to travel, study, travel. You want to

do lots of crazy trips and all. And with passions, you find great passions like surfing, scuba diving.

Speaker2: [01:12:02] And then one of you feels that it's time. The time. They want to start a family. But the other is not ready. The other doesn't want to, they still have lots of things to discover before. Well, the couple will separate. It doesn't mean they don't love each other. It means they are no longer in the same phase. When one person feels ready and feels the need to build a home, they have to build it there, really now, in the [1-5] years that follow, otherwise it will destroy them. And if you force someone who is not in the same phase to do that, it destroys them. So it is not love. Yes, so sometimes we separate because we love each other. The bac is a sacrifice of one person more than others. It has to be. Uh, I don't know how to say. If if. When you love someone, you want the other to be happy. But if the other sacrifices for you to be happy, then it is not love because it means knowing that the other will suffer for you to be happy. Well, it means you don't love them. Accepting that is not good either. So sometimes we separate because we love.

Speaker1: [01:13:14] I would say that this. How important is love in a relationship?

Speaker2: [01:13:19] Well, it's the motor.

Speaker1: [01:13:20] The motor.

Speaker2: [01:13:23] It's the center. But it's also the only thing that brings us back to ourselves. It's the only thing that will reveal our difficulties in relation to the other. It's the only thing that will touch us enough to highlight problems we haven't solved, etc. And that we often solve with a person we live with, but we do the same on the other side, in the way. But these are two parties that learn. But if we take the [Religion] side well, we only learn to become ourselves one day. And a psychologist teaches us to do that too.

Speaker1: [01:14:06] You say it is the only thing that allows us to know ourselves better.

Speaker2: [01:14:12] Yes, in fact, we learn to know ourselves with the other. It can also be with friends, because by reassuring someone. Finally, we want to tell a story about ourselves and we will realize. At that moment. Something about ourselves, but not if we do it intentionally towards us, it doesn't work. On the other hand, if we want to reassure someone, then we are detached from our emotion, so we are for the other, so we don't think anymore, we don't protect ourselves. We will propose. Yes but I already did that and all. I realized that if there and there at the same time we say it, we realize it. Uh.

Speaker1: [01:14:52] By going through a form of dissociation, indeed succeeding in.

Speaker2: [01:14:56] Taking distance to live as a couple.

Speaker1: [01:15:00] It is not made to live as a couple.

Speaker2: [01:15:01] We are made to live in pairs, but not like foxes. We can't live alone, humans. We need relationships, contacts with others, but we are not made physiologically. I don't know what, the brain and what to live with the same person, but it's the opposite sometimes. It's what is rare cases. Uh. It's the case. Where there is love there. After it's I don't speak of comfort. Where there is really love and not an arrangement, because there are goods, because goods also affect a bit, they can. People arrange a bit, it suits them, it doesn't bother them more than that and it suits. But true love actually, if we had to be free of all these material things and all that, yes, true love, well. We are not made for. But sometimes yes.

Speaker1: [01:16:07] What you call true love, it's.

Speaker2: [01:16:11] Well, the other for the other not loving the other for oneself. It's not you missed me, you missed me. I'm unhappy because you're not there. You are guilty of not being there. Look how sad I am. No.

Speaker1: [01:16:28] That is something very difficult to achieve for you.

Speaker2: [01:16:33] I think for people yes, it's difficult, but. I find.

Speaker1: [01:16:37] But it's a goal, it's an objective, something that should be achieved.

Speaker2: [01:16:42] Yes, but actually there is. It is true, but there are the markers we have, there is. If you don't tell someone you missed them, the other thinks you don't love them. Uh, if you are in the hospital or had an accident, they won't say oh what happened? Are you okay? No, it's Hello, you missed me? I'm not well because you're not there. No, I take an extreme too, but well, there you go. And that is. I know, it's actually the other. They are not there just to fill a void. And they are not an object. You take less women, you take men still. The number of women who will re-dress their man to be accepted by her group of friends and and her profession. Uh yeah, he's a biker, he's a biker. The guy won't dress in a suit and tie, it's not the same man anymore. So yes, the woman always wants to improve the man or the partner, will improve, it's normal. She must improve the children in their fulfillment in her work for the kids.

Speaker2: [01:17:58] But the man, apart from understanding, supporting and trusting him, that's all she has to do. A man. And women, it's the same, we don't. You have to seek to know what the other likes if they don't dare. And yes, you can take them to a clothing store. If they are shy, look at the photos, the movies they like and try to find with them something that would suit them and fits their body shape in the mirror, does it suit you? It suits you not? We try something else. Yes, it's not you projecting your thing on the other, it's the other who who who discovers what they like. It's more complicated I think. The other is not. People want to make the other in their image and that's also a problem. They take anyone and then they try to transform them a bit so they fit and then oh, I don't understand, it doesn't work. How come? It's normal? It's not. It's normal that it doesn't work.

Speaker1: [01:18:58] But there is always this notion of continuity of oneself.

Speaker2: [01:19:02] That's it and that's a problem. I think, uh. And I tell you honestly, I live it too, I live it, I live. Yes.

Speaker1: [01:19:13] You. You. You were going to say something?

Speaker2: [01:19:17] No but I live it too. This emotion, I have experienced it, I live it finally. Yes, it's in me, it's like a. A thing that was inculcated to us there. How to be loved by society? How to be accepted, How to be good, How to succeed so that others love us and all. But nobody taught us to love. We were taught from childhood how to be loved, accepted, integrated by others. And so that, we have it in us and it paralyzes couples actually. All this system from childhood, you have to work well at school, you have to obey the teacher, you have to be nice to your mom, you have to be well dressed, you have to smell good. For what? So that others like you? So I find that it's a thing that. What others will think, it's still a very paralyzing thing in the couple, which weighs on everyone, in everyday life, but which weighs on the couple. If there wasn't that. There are many couples who wouldn't argue. If there is also money, huh, still. Uh. Money. If Sonic. Money, money, sex still. Uh. And the role. Because in all couples, actually, we have to try to find a balance in the place we have too. You know.

Speaker1: [01:20:52] You talk to me about love there? You know, you mentioned that there are different forms and ways of loving. You talk to me about how you know that your partner loves you, that your partner loves you.

Speaker2: [01:21:08] Uh. Because she did what she had never done before. Because she put herself in danger by coming to live with me while. I ignored her. I thought it wasn't true. She busted her knees to the point of having to have emergency surgery and having a strict ban on climbing stairs. She still came to my place even though she couldn't climb the stairs. I. I know that. And even more than anyone before. But it's not someone who can express things. That's why it was complicated, because even a man can express it. But she is not used to expressing herself actually. So it was complicated. I went to get her far still. You know how we do with people who have a sort of shell there to remove all the petals and all? She did from the beginning we talked together important research on dyslexia and dyspraxia, subscribed to lots of stuff to talk with families, to try to understand how it worked. There you go. And she took risks. For her life. Risks for to be with me. So yes.

Speaker1: [01:23:01] A little earlier in the interview, you talked about your relationship compared to your previous relationships on certain points and I would like you to talk to me a little more about it. In detail. If you had to compare the quality of your current couple relationship with that of your previous relationships, what could you say about it?

Speaker2: [01:23:23] In. I was different also in your relationship. Uh. With [Name], I didn't argue but I complained a lot. The father of my children, it was a disaster. So that was really horrible. Uh. [Name] We can say that on one side I was settled, relaxed, but on the other side no. There were still a lot of arguments. Still. And with [Partner's Name] we don't argue. Well. We don't agree, we complain or things like that, but we talk about it. But it's not arguments like I experienced before. I don't know where I am tired of it. Why are you saying that? And what. She

has no dominance, it reassures me. [Name]. That's why I left him. He had a dominant side. If we had lived together, he would have imposed things on me. He wanted to redo my whole house. I wanted to redo my house, but in his taste, in his style. And as soon as he wanted dominance, I got angry, but he still had that in him. An Alpha side, he was too. It was not. No, he felt too strong, too powerful. So for me it's dangerous.

Speaker1: [01:25:22] That you felt too powerful.

Speaker2: [01:25:24] He felt powerful.

Speaker1: [01:25:26] That he felt.

Speaker2: [01:25:27] Exactly how they work. Asperger, so. And dyslexic like that. He has a very simple way of functioning. At least it's simple, he can't lie, it's very pleasant. Uh everything he thinks, he thinks sincerely, voluntarily. He really does his best according to his beliefs, according to what he thinks. He is an idealist, he wants to save the world. He fights a lot in the street to defend homosexuals. Uh because we have a lot of gypsies here, so he fights with guys. So he goes also to defend. He is against racism. Well all that is but. We didn't agree on some things so. So there you go.

Speaker1: [01:26:26] But this need for power you described.

Speaker2: [01:26:30] The dominant side. He's an alpha male, he needs to lead his family and I'm already a family mother. And it's the same if he agrees that in a house, it's a woman who decides for the children and that he, he protects the family, that it's his role. Well. He has already been unjust with his son where his son was right. He said he was wrong and. I said that, not here. Then the reason is the reason, you shut up. Whatever the age. We have the right to be wrong, but we. We listen to the other's argument and there you go, We can't impose, we're not the army because not my children because me, no way. Often, only the eldest, he had much more. Finally yeah, he was right most of the time. But he studied for. In fact, each time he studied a file, a subject, he studied it thoroughly. So he said no, technically it's impossible because such and such, here you go. And so there he accepted, but from his own son who has always been raised with authority. Uh well no, even at my place he has no right.

Speaker2: [01:27:48] Uh. Authority, no discussion. Plus, he is against authoritarianism. But he has pride, uh. Because the thing there, it's not pride, it's that thing. Not to say we are wrong or. Not to lower oneself there. To take something as lowering oneself when it is not the case. Anyway. Not pride, it's. Integrity, it's a thing anyway. And that, I don't like that actually. Uh. And since he drank when he had an idea in mind in the evening, it kept spinning. Repeating the same thing. He is never violent, but my son, I know I had said you do that? Otherwise I send you [Name]. [Name] would have said the same thing in a loop for 2 hours. It's worse torture, you can't leave, you know. There you go. Well, we are okay, but after yes, I could have done what I wanted with him if I had wanted, but it's not what I wanted. Uh huh. Otherwise, it's called manipulation. Yes, just give the other exactly what they want, tell them the phrases they want to hear.

Speaker2: [01:29:12] And indeed, you do exactly what you want and get everything you want. But it's not it's not what I wanted actually. Otherwise it's fake. For me it's not, you know. Anyway and. And yes, it's a bit more complicated but I learn a lot. Now, I trust. Uh. It took a long time to open up. To bare ourselves. Many things. The difference is that I don't feel reassured. But not reassured in terms of. In terms of actions. Everything. You have a problem? She finds the solution. She is already on the phone, but at the behavior level. Uh. And I know it's because she doesn't know how to do it. But it's true that it's. I don't feel reassured actually. I need to feel reassured very often and. I think I will have to take some time on that actually. Because she doesn't know how to do things she didn't receive etc. Well, it's things like that and. So uh, that's the only thing actually. And it's related to behavior actually, uh, uh.

Speaker1: [01:31:19] Or on the dichotomy of roles you described earlier. The social roles assigned.

Speaker2: [01:31:25] Yes but after I understand. She doesn't have maternal gestures actually, neither in friendship, nor in. She is not affectionate in the sense. She doesn't put her hand on the cheek, hand in the hair. Uh. It's okay, you'll do better next time. She doesn't have that thing actually. She finds a problem, she solves it actually. There you go, I don't know how to explain. She will do everything to ensure no one ends up in embarrassment, in difficulties. There you go. She is technical actually. She will sacrifice herself. She will get up early in the morning, she will do all the cleaning, all the dishes, all that so that I have nothing to do when I get up.

Speaker1: [01:32:18] But not at the emotional level.

Speaker2: [01:32:20] Yeah, that's it.

Speaker1: [01:32:24] You spoke at the very beginning of the interview, about the fact that what pleased you in [Partner's Name] was her purity. Yes, meaning a. A notion that encompasses a sort of candor and sincerity. Yes. Uh. It's something. That changes compared to your old relationships.

Speaker2: [01:32:51] Yes. Yes yes, because it was where there was a make-believe. Or. All a make-believe anyway. Uh. And then there was. The fact that I couldn't be shared. Uh huh. So I found it very strange. Because me, I share easily the other. Actually. [Partner's Name] can. Excuse me? [Partner's Name] Yes, if I want. Well, if I feel the need or the desire to live an experience, I can do it.

Speaker1: [01:33:46] [Partner's Name] can share you?

Speaker2: [01:33:50] Yes. If I want, an experience or something. Yes. Because otherwise it will affect me. Uh. It will put me in frustration, in loss of confidence, etc. So yes. But. The others. No because they were afraid of losing me. Always for the same reason. They were afraid of losing you. Yeah. But they lost me eventually. Uh huh.

Speaker1: [01:34:25] You also talked about [Partner's Name]?

Speaker2: [01:34:28] Similarly, she proposed to her husband to share her with a woman, wanted to have an experience with a woman. He didn't want for [6-10] years and then he left. Although they could have stayed together. But it's a choice. But. Yes, I think it's part of the important things to understand the other in their history. In their difficulties in. Facing their own fears, the need to face their fears to no longer be afraid. It's part of essential needs actually, for example. A person who intimidates me enormously. I go out with them, they don't intimidate me anymore, I move on. Uh huh.

Speaker1: [01:35:24] You also talked about make-believe?

Speaker2: [01:35:26] Yes, actually, well, I'm tired and old, but before I was pretty. And yes, actually yes. It's true that somewhere yes. We exhibited a bit you know. We played the game, we enjoyed it, we listened, but. I know well that it's flattering, but I hope it's not just that because it bothers me a bit if it's just that. But it's the same in both directions. Seeing a, a woman or a husband who is very beautiful or who has an important profession and used also as that, as make-believe, as social success in the eyes of others. And it's more this need of. In the eyes of others, it is important, it is understandable, but it should not be the main driving force. After that, yes, of course, it is pleasant. If parents appreciate the person we are with for example. But not just because the person is beautiful or earns a lot of money, but also because of the discussion, because the person is funny or not. Well other criteria which are still important.

Speaker1: [01:36:44] No? Always this idea of. The social? Yes, in a certain sense, because.

Speaker2: [01:36:53] That's what bothers me a bit. It's the need for. Central actually. There you go, it hinders the thing. Let's say a couple or lovers who are hidden from everyone's view. A secret couple, for example, lives their love story. And there are. And for me it's the case. I waited a little bit here. Not too much because it's not too much, but generally I wait for it to be a bit more solid before. Because I know that afterwards there will be influences. Thanks to everyone. All the people will give you their. Need to say what they think. They won't say oh well, you don't come, you come that you come? You are two on vacation? Well, add a plate, No it's not that, it's there you go. And the person will be there. So what do you think of my boyfriend? My girlfriend anyway, huh? There is still a thing to make it accepted. So it's the half, the continuation by a group.

Speaker1: [01:38:15] We talk about your relationship compared to your previous relationships. I would like. You to compare the quality of your relationship with that of your friends. What could you say about it?

Speaker2: [01:38:27] With that of my friends? Oh yeah, it's nothing like that as a question. So there, for once, I feel really good. Yeah, yeah, it's really good. Well yes, very well the relationship. Yes because these friends, we know them in depth. That's what you mean? We know the underside of. Oh yes, yes, yes, yes, it's good. I. Well already, what is important, is that there are no lies. It bugged, didn't it? Oh no, it's good. So there is that. Uh. We are really. Two helpers together so actually. She helps me and I help her. She helps me and my children and I help her uh each. We have areas where we are more or less, we have facilities. And we both

have fragile health too. So when we are tired, it's not the other and we are very much in the in the mutual aid. Uh. So that is uh, it's important. And that, it's. I haven't found that in any couple around me. Uh. We talk a lot, but. But uh. We manage to understand each other, but it takes time. So. I'm quite happy because generally, people talk a lot but don't understand each other at all still. Finally, they continue their. Thing. Each one says their thing, but each stays in their. Thing and think they listen to the other but they don't listen that much actually.

Speaker2: [01:40:37] And there you go. And we question ourselves quite often trying to. Readjust, to find each other in the second. No, I am quite happy with my relationship with [Partner's Name], compared to the people I know around me and friends and all. Because I know that we will always be able to count on each other and even if we separate. Even if one day we are no longer in love, we know that we are friends. Yeah, and that we tell each other everything actually and that we won't. There are no lies, there are no. Uh. Which means that even when [Partner's Name]'s friends tried to do things behind our back. Everything that is said, that is done is in the open actually. So that has always made me strong and has always allowed me to. To be able to because they tried to manipulate her, to destabilize her. But it didn't work because we are two. From the moment we are two, well. Oh but you don't know the last time? Yes yes, it's even me who told her to go. So there you go, there is a whole. There was a friend downstairs, a neighbor who said Yeah, I want to sleep with [Partner's Name], she wanted to sleep with [Partner's Name] and I told [Partner's Name], go ahead frankly, since you find.

Speaker2: [01:42:18] You always have a sort of inferiority complex compared to her and that you think. You will see that her pedestal will fall right away, you will feel super comfortable, you will see her true face. And so go ahead. [Partner's Name] doesn't remember anything, they both got drunk, they fell asleep. And so, the mirage there, the thing where you are never good enough, that you were always better than her and all. And so, it's like her face had changed. She saw all her wrinkles, she saw all her flaws, etc. So you knew it would do that actually. And so her goal was to break our couple actually. And so when she came. Uh. Well, she was surprised that [Partner's Name] was aware and so she used it to go up and go up where it was good and all. So how did it go and all? And so it can never be a problem, but if she hadn't done it, she would always have felt that she was better than her, stronger than her. One. And there, she is even crawling in front of her. They committed lots of nonsense in fast boat, lots of mean things and she is trying to catch up and [Partner's Name] no longer has. She no longer has a hold on her emotionally.

Speaker1: [01:43:41] Uh Sorry. No, I. Go ahead. We are here to listen and know your feelings and your experience. Uh. You talked to me about many things, what constituted for you, what constituted romantic relationships. And I would like you to talk to me about what is for you a high-quality relationship.

Speaker2: [01:44:10] Ah yes, okay. So for me, a high-quality relationship does not matter if you live together or not. But don't be too far anyway in the same city. It is. Good that there are not too many sacrifices on both sides. And that each has moments for themselves. As a deep identity whether it's an activity, something they do not together actually, whether it's going to see their friends, playing poker, whether it's going to a painting activity, whether it's doing, there you

go. And that on both sides and. And doing things together too. There is a balance actually. And. The ideal is in relation to the character of the two people. [Partner's Name] is much more speedy than me, so she will do more outside things than me and I don't want to feel obliged to go all the time. I prefer her to go do things with her friends and I do my things and some things together, but not everything and. It's the trust. But the real trust, you know. And that's important. Tell each other everything. Uh. After it's true that you have to try to be careful how you say things too, that can be hurtful or not at all. It's. But it's the same thing said, uh.

Speaker2: [01:46:02] And a rhythm, a balance of rhythm actually. A bit like two roommates living together. I take the roommate because the roommate doesn't encroach on the intimacy of the other. And they juggle. Actually, we don't necessarily go to the kitchen at the same time, there you go, we make pasta, we say do you want some more? There you go, quite simple like that and being together, but not. Vampire on the other hand. There you go. But all that is trust actually. When you are sure. When you are sure of the other's love, when you trust the other, you are no longer in anxiety. So you don't need constant proofs of love and you don't worry and you won't misinterpret things either. So the main thing is this trust in the love that the other has for you. A bit like if you were on two thrones, you see the king, the queen and that suddenly that place is uh it is not. It is sure. After, it also means that you have to always be vigilant. Uh To understand the other, to be attentive and to discuss. It's not action actually, it's more understanding, supporting. And there you go. That's all. Actually, there are no other things.

Speaker2: [01:47:42] After the ideal, of course, it's better to have money than not to have it. But as long as people are like a team. And suddenly, the person can take risks. They know they will not end up alone in trouble, you see. So they can work together. And as long as there is this trust there, knowing that two things to work together and when the intention of one and the other is certain. Suddenly, there is this strength there which means that nothing is serious and nothing is important. Finally, nothing is serious because there will always be a solution for two. We always find solutions. So it's more a matter of in the. There actually. That's why a house with a swimming pool is. It's really in the consciousness of being convinced of knowing, of being sure of the other's honesty, of telling each other things, of trusting each other and oneself. And suddenly, if there is a problem, we solve it together without having to say I will lose my marbles, then I will find myself alone, I will have no more marbles. There you go, so that's what. And from there, it's a teamwork and it's strong. And well. There are no problems, there are only solutions.

Speaker2: [01:49:13] So suddenly, we are much more serene, we are no longer jealous, we no longer need to be reassured, even if we are still reassured on a daily basis. But from the moment where, since the discussion of little things that will reassure the other. But suddenly they will no longer need to be reassured because they will be reassured and it's to be convinced inside oneself. That it's okay. That we are not being taken advantage of. That there is nothing fishy. That We are sure of the other, of their thoughts. But whatever their thoughts. That's what's important. Because the lie is. There are two reasons for the lie, it's either we are afraid the other will leave us or we are afraid they won't accept the situation. But otherwise, if the person accepts the situation. No need to lie. No, it's not exactly the same because. From my experience, it was because married men liked it because it was forbidden. So suddenly. Married men have relationships because it was exciting because it was forbidden only because it was

forbidden. Unhealthy. If it was official, finally, it would lose its charm actually. Uh. Yes, in that it works. It doesn't work in that case. But. But yes, I think it's not the place. It's not the income.

Speaker2: [01:50:42] Uh, it's to be convinced deep inside, the trust on both sides. And the sincerity and tell each other everything. We have the right not to be in love anymore, we have the right to fall in love with someone else, we have the right, we have the right to discuss it, to respect the other, to inform them, to talk about what we believe and without it taking huge proportions. And if the two really love each other, they can leave being unhappy and then come back two days later to talk. We are humans, we can't either. But there you go, there are no lies. The betrayal is the lie. It's not necessarily the act itself, it's not being aware and not being able to make decisions about it. And suddenly, if that is clear. Well. What can we be afraid of finally? Not much. Because all, all that poses a problem, it's fears, fears of what others will think, fears of being taken advantage of, fears of being abandoned, fears of being betrayed, of being a fool who gives everything and finally there you go, it's only fears actually, if you remove the fear factor, you put the trust factor. Suddenly there are a lot fewer problems.

Speaker1: [01:52:00] If I understand correctly. The most important notion is trust. Because it unites all the other notions, it underlies. It allows the expression of all the other notions you have expressed, which are therefore trust and communication.

Speaker2: [01:52:14] That's right?

Speaker1: [01:52:18] Uh. You talked a little bit about it, you mentioned it, but how? How can we know we are in a relationship of trust?

Speaker2: [01:52:27] We can't know. It takes time. Uh huh. You have to open up the other. But the thing is that already you have to see how there is. Or how the person was with another person before. After. Yeah, my daughter is taking an ice cream from the fridge. And no, you don't climb, are you crazy? Are you crazy. And suddenly, there is that, there is the fact of having access to everything also on the other if we want to. Because we have access, we won't necessarily go there. But it's discussions, discussions also, managing to say what we feel, what we don't feel in situations that are not necessarily only in our couple, but being flattered by a compliment, etc. There is therefore how to behave with other people and there are small factors actually. Uh for example, uh, there are people who are very bad, who live very badly to lie because they have to and it prevents them from sleeping and they are not well and already you see that the person has a bit of trouble lying still.

Speaker2: [01:54:00] After I admit that I do investigations at the beginning, I check everything because I went out with liars still. My husband is a nice man, but he is a pathological liar. Uh. But really pathological. Really. But. And so I checked everything. All the time, all the time, all the time. So at the beginning, yes, you check actually. Well, you don't have another choice huh? Yes, you can blindly trust saying Fear doesn't prevent danger. And I'm not sure it works, huh. Uh. I think still questions. It works, it ruminates. No, I think you have to check for real after, to avoid feeling uncomfortable in the relationship, say, explain sincerely that there you go, I had relationships before with people who were not necessarily sincere and I need time and don't be

surprised if I check things, don't take it personally. There you go, I need time to trust again and people, I think they can understand that normally. There you go.

Speaker1: [01:55:10] You talk to me about what is for you a high-quality relationship which is mainly characterized by trust and communication, among others. Uh. I would like you to talk to me about what is for you a low-quality relationship.

Speaker2: [01:55:29] Uh. But when you don't trust the other actually. When you are afraid. Uh.

Speaker1: [01:56:11] It's annoying.

Speaker2: [01:58:22] There you go. Now it's written in Spanish, in English. And there you go.

Speaker1: [02:01:21] Or can you hear me?

Speaker2: [02:01:22] Yes, so it's much simpler the other way around. Uh when it's the same thing, but it's because I haven't found arguments in that sense. When the way of managing finances of one of the two impacts that of the other. When there is no discussion, balanced arrangements that manage to constitute a bit, like I told you, the travel card, the accounts, the basket, all that. Or when there is one who also suddenly cannot access although theoretically they have the means, to leisure activities they like because there is a bad distribution at the financial level of bad agreements. It must remain fair. Both people must be able to do things and there you go, that's important. The financial level is very, very important in the balance of the couple. It's to find a balance in the way of managing a thousand ways of managing differently. There are where it's the women who take care of everything that is food and they are professionals with discount coupons, I don't know how to do that but well there you go. Uh there you go, everyone has their thing, sometimes it's one of the two who manages everything because they have the ability to manage that kind of thing, to be very square and who says there you go, there is a monthly leisure budget or a budget that is so much. And there you go. You put little virtual envelopes for birthdays, etc.

Speaker2: [02:03:06] That's important. Uh. After it's the fact of knowing that when something happens to the person, if they don't discuss to solve the problem together. Uh. Saying it's your problem, not mine. Uh, it doesn't work either. It's when there is no balance actually. What it is when there is one who is frustrated compared to the other, when there is one who sacrifices for the other to be well? Uh, it can be sacrificed for the children too, it can also be when suddenly there is one who who commits a bit less. Suddenly the other does everything. Or vice versa. Often women who don't want, who don't let the man or the partner who is not the mother, get involved in the education and who don't leave room for men. There is a matter of place too in the couple. A sort of place that must be discussed and that suits both, etc. In the couple itself, whatever it is and in the couple with children whether it's their own children or not, and even when it's their own children. Sometimes the other, the one who is not the mother, uh doesn't necessarily find their place, sometimes they don't have one or sometimes it is not clear. And there you go, the place, the place is important that it is discussed. There is no rule, it really

depends on the two characters, it's that this place is discussed, it, is there are words on it, that it is clear.

Speaker2: [02:04:43] The role of each. In the parental role. The role of each in the couple. In the couple, even if they resemble each other, even if they are the same. It must be said, it must be uh uh. Not on a paper contract, but it must be clear that, and financially, it is very important. What will add costs is the feeling, it's the feeling, it's a story, it's the feeling of being abused or that we abuse the other. It's the feeling of being financially dependent on someone. It can be the feeling of, of, of, of carrying everything, it can be that, all that, it doesn't work, it doesn't work. People have the right to manage their money as they want. From the moment when a common rule is found that is common to each person, with an account that corresponds to the budget of things of life and financial freedom. Each has their account to do what they want. You don't invite your wife. You don't offer your wife a gift with the common account. It's. You want, you want, you can buy cigarettes or stuff without having to justify it. You have your own account, with your own money, your savings that each one does what they want, with the one who wants to spend it all spends it all. It's their character, their way of living. It must not impact on the other person, who moreover is a saver.

Speaker2: [02:06:26] There you go, they must not be the same. So the one who saves ends up paying for everyone's vacations either. So it must be something that is discussed very clearly all the time on we want, we want to do a vacation project and how we are going to do it, There you go. And a discussion where each one feels good, that they feel uh there you go. And if there is one who feels and that's why discussion is important, who feels they pay more and that it bothers them and that they feel because and that they feel that well yeah, listen your personal development sessions, me for the family, I find it's normal, that my budget is bigger, my income, bigger etc. But there I find it is not fair. And well the other will take a job on the side for the neighbor because that's how we do now. And well to pay for their little sessions, it will be their personal desire that exceeds the budget of something with the two incomes in common. Us, the system we had found, I found it good. But well, there could be lots of examples given to people of balance, of budget system so that it is fair. Uh. And that there is not one who feels richer or poorer than the other, That is important that there is not one who feels they pay everything, that there is not one who feels they are financially dependent.

Speaker2: [02:07:59] There you go. Each has the same feeling of financial independence of each, has the feeling of being able to do what they want with their money. Which is on their account. But which has a common account that serves for I don't know. I don't know exactly because there I manage my house and [Partner's Name] manages hers. For now, we haven't done this system because we will do it only when we are together. Uh in the subject, the food budget. Which is the main one. Because, after all the monthly bills, insurance and all that, each has their personal insurance, each their stuff. After you have the rent which is divided in two or sometimes not at all, it depends on the arrangement, but it doesn't change and after that, it's each taken from their personal account. After, there is the part that is decided to be attributed to each. It must be equal. And the basket must represent a sum that corresponds to the expenses. Of the normal house. Because if you want, you can. Like that, it allows you to say today I invite you to the cinema, there you go, with your own money, you see. And so it remains that. You

keep your dignity, you keep. Money is super important in the couple. After, it is the balance at the level. The needs, the needs, the needs to see friends and the needs to be alone and the needs to be together. That is super important because a bad couple, it is a couple where.

Speaker2: [02:09:44] There is one who will go out all the time. Uh the other will stay all the time at home, so there is something wrong and who runs away. There you go, There is no sharing of everything the daily things, the sharing of problems, the sharing of bills or problems. It's the same, a problem to solve, things that are not necessarily fun sometimes. I don't know, I take the cleaning. [Name] proposed him it's or we do the cleaning together or we hire a cleaning lady once a week or once a month, it costs 20 bucks. On our budget, we calculate at worst, there are always solutions actually. To avoid frustration. It can be simply paying a cleaning lady once a month just to do the annoying stuff, we don't know, but there are solutions, but it just needs to be stated, that it is clear. When it is not clear, it's rotten. Yeah there you go. And all household chores must be discussed, that's why each one's place actually. The role of each must be discussed, it's not true. As much as we say that to children as to adults, it is done naturally. No, it is not done naturally, it's not true. Uh. There is always one who will be impatient or a more perfectionist side who will do it and that finally says I do it because you don't do it although we didn't leave the other time to do it.

Speaker 2: [02:11:07] No, no, it's not clear, it's a mess. And then you say, well no, I don't have time to do it, you're already done. So, problem, argument, all that. So cleaning is something important. Money is something you have to discuss and balance out. Otherwise, it's not a couple, it's a nightmare. And each person's needs, the need to go out, the need for, "I'd love to, I wish we could go one day, I'd like to..." They don't have. Yes, I'm disappointed. I thought I'd wanted to go to that party because you knew it was important to me. No, neither a man nor a woman is divine, otherwise, it's a job. We are seers, right? Clear? No, it's really straightforward. There you go, these are talked-about projects. If we do something that pleases one person twice, then when you can say, well look, seriously, I'm glad I did that with you, but now I want us to do something for me, it's my turn. So, it's discussing everything absolutely. And always the feeling that neither of them feels more than the other, even if the other doesn't feel it. It only takes one person to feel this damn emotion, and it's no longer a couple, it's a mess. It's no longer balanced, it's ruined.

Speaker 1: [02:12:23] Yeah, if I understand what you're saying, there's really a strong notion of place and role in the couple. Once again, with each maintaining their integrity while creating this vase you talked about at the beginning of the interview, but also keeping, yes, their place, their integrity, their own person within the emerging couple relationship.

Speaker 2: [02:12:46] Because love is also admiration for the other. And how can you admire someone who no longer exists? Otherwise, they become a part of you. Then, at that moment, they become furniture, you move them around occasionally, you dust them off, and then it's no longer a couple and it's over. There's nothing left. The person becomes transparent, for one or the other, and then it doesn't work anymore. There needs to be resistance, there need to be discussions, you must disagree sometimes, there needs to be resistance, a person facing you, even if it's full of discussions, but with the awareness that if one of the two doesn't try to

understand the other's needs, it won't work. That doesn't mean we will meet all the other's needs, no? To balance out. And it's a lifetime's work. That's why some say a couple is a lifetime's work, but it is a lifetime's work. Sometimes you find a routine, a system that works. Some go see a football match with their buddies every Friday night. Some go clubbing once a month with their friends. I don't know, but it could be a drink at the neighbor's, I don't know, but it doesn't matter, the important thing is to find something.

Speaker 1: [02:14:13] Hmm. You talked to me about what was a high-quality relationship for you and a low-quality relationship. And I would like you to talk to me about other things that are most important to you in a romantic relationship.

Speaker 2: [02:14:27] Ah yes, I forgot, sex is super important in a couple, actually. And actually, it takes a lot of time. Hmm. Also, because, um, you don't do the same things with each person differently, because each person is different, there's no thing. There's no possible comparison, actually. You live a different story with each person and each person. Everything is different, actually. You can't achieve something, the same thing. With another person. Because otherwise, you go back with the other person. It's stupid, but that's also important. The discussion also about that. Understanding each other, spending time alone. A couple. Trying to have moments to oneself too, to the couple, I mean the couple, not to oneself. And sometimes also trying to understand oneself, talking about it. And sometimes understanding that not everyone is ready at the same time for the same things. Meaning not everyone has the time to ask themselves questions, I mean. That it's not always the other who is to blame for anything. That's easy, actually. It's to say how we are going to do in this situation, us? How we are going to build our us? Because we are not others, we are different and take time to understand how we are going to do and ask ourselves questions about what makes us vibrate or not, remembering things and why we think it's complicated or not and try to express it and try to understand each other and the other feels that.

Speaker 2: [02:16:30] Well, because there's a lot of. There's sex itself, but, uh, there's a lot. A man as much as a woman can be very quickly hurt sexually. It's something very fragile, both for one and the other. Men, uh. Especially, the world is rather ruthless towards men. Men. A man. It's very ruthless because then women are horrible to men in relation to that. Meaning they are asked to be performant and performant for each woman differently. So with one you have to be gentle, delicate, the other you have to be a brute. Well, it's nonsense. That's why sometimes girls start with that. Actually, if it works, hop on, if it sticks, if our ways of being match, we will see if we can go further.

Speaker 2: [02:17:34] And with a girl. But then it's a bit different because it's. The relationship is different in the sense that you find yourself much less face to face in the thing, where the bodies become one and fit together, and all that where there is a very we abandon ourselves to each other, there is not really that. There's a bit of each one's turn. So then, there's also a time to revisit love, actually. And it's a time that takes. And I would even say that I didn't necessarily appreciate my sex life, actually, at the beginning with, as it went on, actually. Because I also liked the need for love. You fill up, you kiss the other, you are absorbed by them, etc. You feel the other's emptiness. And then these two emptinesses are there, yes, but I'm talking on the

level. Actually, you build with what the other is and then and you after you love and but, and, but sincerely, each one is different and it takes time. It takes time too. And that too, to be clear about frustrations. To arrive at really understanding the other as they are.

Speaker 2: [02:19:06] It's not my case, but there are men who like to be submissive. Isn't it a man? That's why. And then the woman has to be able to hear it too. It's not because a man has. Men, proof that sodomy is being submissive. Anyway. But they say I'm not gay, you see. And whereas it's normal, the anal nerve endings of a man are 3 to 4 times more sensitive than those of a woman. And even for me, I was super jealous, it's not possible and all, it's something we will never have. And then no, it's really being comfortable where everyone discovers the other's body, the parts they like and don't. And it doesn't necessarily happen the first time, nor the second because we don't know the other. And then there's a kind of trust to abandon oneself to the other. If it's just something basic with dominance where each one is on their thing. Well, okay, it can be fun, it's like in the movies, but then if it's really going deeper into the other's intimacy, it's at a moment where both must feel confident. Already not telling, keeping it to oneself and then keeping it in our us which is part of our life.

Speaker 2: [02:20:31] And that's it. Because. And really arriving at loving the other for what they are. And if there are things we can't do, with which we are not comfortable, arriving at discussing it all knowing. That if one of the two is frustrated with something. Uh, it's going to be a problem at some point. Hmm. That must be understood. Yeah. It's not like someone with whom we don't talk and one day we don't know why the person went somewhere else. Here we can say we don't know, from the moment we discuss, we know, we have a certain responsibility, we know that if there's not one of the two who responds to the other's expectations, well then at some point, if the discussion is closed, well there's a risk that the couple breaks or that we are cheated on or or. Or that one of the two is not happy, unhappy, not fulfilled at least. And sex is also very important. Because normally if we are happy, but if it becomes the opposite. It's not good. So it's money, sex, and trust.

Speaker 1: [02:21:45] You talked about the fact that at the beginning you weren't comfortable with your sexuality. Were you referring to your sexuality in general or to your lesbian sexuality?

Speaker 2: [02:21:54] Lesbian, even in general? Hmm.

Speaker 1: [02:21:59] Even in general.

Speaker 2: [02:22:01] Yes. No, because actually I discover. Well, at the beginning you pretend, huh, You act like finally. All people the first time they are going to have sex with a person for the first time. Actually, both are super scared, even if they pretend they handle the situation very well. It's false. Because even if there's enthusiasm and all that, if it's a one-night stand, nobody cares. But we tend to let go, let's say. But there's still. Otherwise, for the rest, if there are feelings or things, it will still be something where each one is nervous, actually, even if it doesn't show. So it's not necessarily the moment when we are going to have the most. We are not going to abandon ourselves so easily to the other and it will be only gradually. And after we get used to each other's bodies, techniques, fantasies that are part of the construction of us, a mix

between theirs and theirs. But which will be. For example, it's not necessarily sexual but. I love spooning people and generally people fall asleep in my arms after, so they get used to it too, even if they didn't know it before. Actually. So after that, you miss something? Even that you didn't know. Like I love spooning everyone. Because it's not that I love hugging people, holding all that.

Speaker 2: [02:23:39] Well, even if it's a person who is not used to physical contact, after they will impose, they will do the same as you by imitation, because they will feel comfortable in their own body, because it has been touched, and they will be able to reciprocate and all that. But after that, even if it's something different that you didn't experience before, well, you will like it, You will get used to it. It can be humor. There are people who have a lot of humor in sexuality, it can destabilize you the first few times, but then you can love it and add jokes. Anyway, there you go. And so there's a construction of the thing that gets better over time. Sometimes it's the opposite, but that's passionate love, actually it's desire. Only it's not sexuality, well it's desire. And desire is because the person doesn't belong to you, they never belong to you. It's not acquired, it's not desire, we desire what we don't have. So there you go, in that system. And then there can be a. A dead time with habits, stuff, preoccupations. But. But that's not necessarily something that will last. You can have a passion 100% without necessarily. Uh, abandoning yourself to the other. So uh.

Speaker 1: [02:25:08] A distinction between desire and sexuality.

Speaker 2: [02:25:12] Uh, between desire and love.

Speaker 1: [02:25:17] Desire, love.

Speaker 2: [02:25:20] Yeah well yes, actually yes. A bit. But it's very complicated. I know that he. I said, I didn't want to be in a couple because I thought sexually, it would ruin us. Because. When you see that for that you do only that. It's like if you go to the gym, you go to the gym, gym, you only think about the gym. But as soon as you are in a couple, actually, you can be in your bed and think about accounting, the laundry. What you have to do tomorrow? And I found that very dangerous as. Because then, as long as it's dissociated, it removes a lot of problems.

Speaker 1: [02:26:11] It removes a lot of problems.

Speaker 2: [02:26:13] Yeah and a lot of problems that come after when you are in a couple. Yeah, as long as you are not, they don't exist yet. The couple can. Sexuality, actually.

Speaker 1: [02:26:34] What is the role for you of sexuality in a couple relationship?

Speaker 2: [02:26:40] But it's the only difference with friendships. Hmm. A. There's exactly like being the woman of your life. It's still in sexual fulfillment too. It's finding a. Uh to flourish, to continue to move forward too, always in the [Religion] continuity, always moving forward, discovering each other, learning from each other. Uh. And. Actually, there is a sexual dependence and an emotional dependence a bit that is linked in all this, which means that even if there are things that don't work, it can bind a couple. It can bind two beings. Actually. Uh. It

can reconcile people too. Some seek conflict just to uh. Because when it happens, it blocks people, they argue, but they can never make love together. Some are the opposite. Because conflict implies separation. This separation means the other no longer belongs to you. So they become desire. The desired thing that doesn't belong to you. And it will rekindle sexual desire. I only know two scenarios in my life, so a man. And there's the secret of a partner. And that's why keeping one's individuality. With the common pot which is what we do together to build a family. It can be. And the evening? Also means there will still be admiration for the other. The fact that the other is not necessarily available, that they have their yoga class and that you have to seduce them too to.

Speaker 2: [02:28:47] And the fact that the other doesn't belong to you and that the only thing that belongs to you is the common pot, I think it can be good like. The story of desire is complicated, actually. And some are fusion, who desire the other because they can't do without the other, because they need the other. But since these two fusion dependents together, actually, it works. But. But otherwise in many cases, when they belong to each other. That's the word, it's belonging. That's what's annoying. And it's not I love them and they say they love. You see, not the fact of loving someone? It's the fact of belonging. So yes, trust must be important, but trust in the fact that we tell each other everything and we can count on each other but not in belonging. Because belonging is the opposite of desire. I think we only desire what we don't have. If we have it, we no longer desire it. You want to buy Superman, once you have it? Well then you want to buy the helmet after the mouse. After, finally, you will buy roller skates, you will use them for a week and then you are bored. Especially since we are in a consumer environment so. Hmm. Women and men are never more flirted with than when they are single in a couple. Sorry? So uh. I don't know. So there is all that actually.

Speaker 1: [02:30:30] There you go. Sexuality plays an important role in the couple.

Speaker 2: [02:30:34] Yes. Actually, if sex doesn't work, if financially it doesn't work. Uh well. Okay, it's friendship. At that moment, you become friends.

Speaker 1: [02:30:55] There you go, the only difference between friendships and couple relationships is sexuality. And the desire that goes with it.

Speaker 2: [02:31:03] Yes well yes, it's the only difference. Normally you don't desire your friends, right? Hmm. However, you can. However, you can desire to spend time with them. You can love someone's company, you can love their humor, you can love talking with that person, you can have a very strong affection, strong You have friendships that are not fusion but that are very strong. There you go. But you don't see the leg, you don't see the person naked? There is no desire in. There is no desire on the sexual level, which makes the difference, otherwise it can't be a friend. Actually, it can't be a friend. It's funny, huh?

Speaker 1: [02:31:56] Uh. Can there be desire in love? Love that is not passionate.

Speaker 2: [02:32:05] Yes. Yes. Yes but there it's because I'm discovering uh. Recently so uh, uh yes, uh. But actually, there is a time for patterns and that's personal to each one. Meaning

uh, for example. If you have only had very passionate stories, so as negative as positive, very strong actually, your body, your mind will seek that dose of adrenaline which is yet very complicated, very difficult and which makes you very unhappy. And then, it takes a rather long time to arrive at. To accept that love can be, is not necessarily suffering and that what you have as strong emotions, finally, is suffering and not love. So that's quite. It's the path we are used to taking and towards which we go and the new things that take time to, to. To go because finally after you can go only in situations where it can't work because finally. It reaches strong situations, very strong emotions and that's rather complicated for me, that. It's true that if the person doesn't kneel, crying, I feel like they don't love me. A. If they don't say ten times a day that you are the most beautiful thing that ever happened to me.

Speaker 2: [02:33:50] I feel like shit. After if you were a singer and you have thousands of people applauding you and. And then you don't have it anymore, you will still seek it. Because then one person applauding you won't be enough, you will feel unloved. So it's a bit of a relationship with one's personal history and. So it's true that personally, if I'm not told often that. That the day I met you, it's the most beautiful day of my life or I saw the best thing that ever happened to me. Where? I would do anything for you, etc. But then it's true that if there's not that. Uh. I tend to feel unloved, not reassured. Actually, that's it. Even if there are many acts. There are things that are words. The words are. I had only words and it's only lies and nothing beside it works either. But words are also very important. So maybe not the only, but in any case yes, for me it's very important.

Speaker 1: [02:35:16] You talked about the notion of desire. And if I understand what you told me, there are several types of desire too. There's sexual desire that you develop at the very beginning, and then there's desire in love that may not be related to sexuality or in love anyway, that may be friendly love or relationship love.

Speaker 2: [02:35:37] Yeah, that's complicated, I find. Balance and balance is complicated. It's a bit less complicated if there are no children. Uh. But after, when you have children, there are women's weekends, mothers' weekends. It cuts a bit, it removes a bit of spontaneity. But I mean, it's uh. When a couple is alone in a house where you wander naked all day, it's not a problem. After, unless you have nudist or very hippie children in an imaginary world, generally you are dressed in a house and. And you are not on the living room table while the other is playing on the PlayStation. So indeed, there are things that will hinder everything that is natural. Uh. On the level of desire, actually, which will be of. Spontaneity or of the moment. That's a bit of it. That's why often people find it much more fun to have sex at the office than at home in the evening from 8:30 pm. But it's complicated. Yes, it's complicated. It's a complicated balance. I don't have the recipe yet.

Speaker 1: [02:37:05] You talked about sexuality. Are you satisfied with your sex life?

Speaker 2: [02:37:11] Hmm. No, I know it's on pause. Well, I know. That there were all these breaks and then, uh, and these back and forths and uh, managing my fatigue and managing these pains, uh no, uh. Ah, if [Partner's Name] reproached me, I would cry because then, she is responsible for all that. I had told her if you say stop to my sexual fulfillment, since I'm

Asperger's, I'm in open bar, I'm obsessed with only one thing and I go all in. And if you remove your thing, I remove everything. Like someone who quits smoking. You smoke or all cigarettes or zero? And then I did a sort of internal suicide saying well, listen, I stay with you so I cut off my sexuality. So indeed, after restarting it, it's more complicated. Uh and actually with these back and forths and so, we weren't lucky, very sincerely, with these back and forths. Only important problems to solve. We only did that and so we were in function, that is, doing groceries, etc. etc. And indeed, I can't be in several functions at the same time. Uh. After, I'm not worried though. The difference? A. Because I know she can't reproach me, even if she wants to, because she is responsible, that I had warned her how I functioned and that I had said that even though it was something very important for me, but that I know that functionally, theoretically, rationally, we will be able to find each other when we move into our apartment together.

Speaker 2: [02:39:03] Hmm. Because running at the same time, it's not possible. Being on edge at the same time. Being in warrior mode at the same time. Yeah, I'm coming. Okay. Yeah. Super. No? Well, damn, what do we need? Damn, Tomorrow we have to get up at 6 am, okay? That can't be possible like that. Hmm. It's complicated. It's No. You can't be in a rush, spending your time solving problems and being in urgency. Already in urgency. You can't even be creative. At the same time. So no, you can't. I can't be on edge when you are tired, fighting, battling and on edge. It doesn't work. Except if it was a dominant relationship. Well, if it was the person pinning you against a wall, you see. But that's not the case with [Partner's Name]. She has a gentle sexuality, but then indeed, it could have been possible because then you take the person out of the cycle. And then you go back. But right now, I know it's not possible and at the point where we are, very sincerely. I think that since the main goal is for us to live together to solve all these problems. After, I desire her with much more gentleness, me who liked to be pinned against walls. So then I discover a different desire, a desire that makes the us. But it doesn't bother me.

Speaker 2: [02:40:38] It's a fact. Well. Hmm. We couldn't have done otherwise. We took a risky bet, a bet where we live 10 kilometers apart with each having health problems. With my children. That is, preparing, cooking quickly before rushing to be there for a week with her, I have to do in a week what I do in two weeks. No way around it. So then, no, no. This situation has exhausted me a lot, morally, physically and [Partner's Name] too, and very sincerely. We have invested so much to make it work despite all. All the obstacles we have crossed together. So then, I'm not worried because I mean in [Month], I'm enjoying my children to the maximum, my daughter mainly my son who will come in [Month] whom I see only once a year and and my daughter because I had her for [1-5] year and a half with me, but I had her at fourteen. She is already an apprentice everywhere, enjoying this time with my children to the maximum. The children don't always go and and it's very important to enjoy them. Their presence. And there, look, [Month] Yellow is a bit related to her comedy school to be a comedian. So mid-[Month], she starts. In the meantime, we will move and [name] is in boarding school and weekends. So if we live together, time for us, we will have only that.

Speaker 1: [02:42:36] You said never sure if I understand. You said that at the beginning you cut off sexuality. Is that precisely a discussion you had. What were the exact reasons that led to this choice?

Speaker 2: [02:42:50] Uh. Because we are an open couple and she didn't want to anymore. Then I died inside and then I had. Because actually, at first, I didn't want to be in a couple because I still had a lot to discover and flourish. So there you go. And [Partner's Name] told me no, it doesn't bother me. Uh. So I said okay then. If I can have both. I said yes, I sign. And after a while, I admit I had never, never. I admit I still. And then I said okay but then I stop everything actually, for me it blocked me, it cut everything off actually. I mean, that's what is there, that's what was going to happen.

Speaker 1: [02:43:41] It wasn't carried over actually. It wasn't transferring the security you could have with other people in other contexts. In this open relationship context, it wasn't transferring to the exclusive relationship you have with [Partner's Name]. No.

Speaker 2: [02:43:55] Especially that actually. Uh. She had inflammatory crises where I couldn't touch her. She had all the time. Well, it was complicated where she could barely do 50, she could do almost no position. Well, it was complicated also. And I actually, I don't know how to explain that, but I'm hypersensitive anyway. But. I manage, I compartmentalize. I say okay, it's not possible. Well okay, I put that. We put it in a box, we take care of it next year. So now the priority is that. And it doesn't bother me that. If it's not possible, it's not possible. If I can't get my driver's license this year, I'll get it next year. So then I got used to that and then restarting the other way was complicated.

Speaker 1: [02:44:50] Uh. You told me that right now.

Speaker 2: [02:44:54] I had experienced it as a betrayal actually. Yeah, because I wouldn't have signed actually somewhere if she hadn't told me that, you see. And that also made me feel she was pure. You see. And then I felt like a betrayal anyway.

Speaker 1: [02:45:13] An ambivalence in your feeling, both you experienced it as a betrayal and at the same time you did not doubt her sincerity and that she told you, you experienced it as a. A. A display of her purity a.

Speaker 2: [02:45:33] And then. Well actually I have insane sexual blockages so then my father was an alcoholic so he called me [redacted] I don't know, [20-25] times a day. [Redacted]. I know it had consequences, huh, That. My father is a disaster on that. And then, I had a total cut-off and uh. And it's only at [30-35] years old, there, when I went out with, uh, at the death of my father actually, when still, the death of my father freed me from his superego or I don't know what crap there, his hold or I don't know what And uh. And after [Name] who loved me as I am. I was hugely self-conscious about my body. And then also, since my brother, my father said I was the devil, I aroused others' desire. I was amused by my father's friends anyway. And it's my fault in short, you see. And then, with hindsight, I was [6-10] years old. No, I'm not responsible as an adult, no. And as a child, I thought I was cursed. Actually it was my fault. So then it really messed up my sexuality.

Speaker 2: [02:47:14] No kidding. And so it took a lot longer and since I was going to go there. No because I was still jealous. There is a reality. Meaning all my girlfriends, we girls talk a lot

about sex. Actually, boys, I don't know, but girls, yeah, a lot. And so they tell us, they tell us everything. Me I have. And then I was the confidant, enormously more confidant than anything else. Because well, there you go. And then I knew all their sex lives vicariously actually. And I felt super handicapped then. You see? And. And then, the fact of feeling loved and no longer dissociated from my body because there is a dissociation in these situations, and then it's like it was put back together, you see. And then I felt desired, I was touched, caressed, loved. And then I had desires and all that, I felt things, I feel much less maybe than some people, but I still feel a lot of things. And so then in my momentum, you see, well then I wanted to, you see, after I had one person, after another it didn't work, I thought yes, he gave me that before dying, let's say somehow, you see. And I have to continue in my delirium, in my head, you see. And so there you go, there was that and and and and then it blocked me because I thought it was important for me to achieve myself actually.

Speaker 2: [02:48:47] To free myself from my frustrations. It's not a love story at all. It was to face my fears and learn to know myself. Learn to know who I am, how I function, etc. And so there you go, yes that blocked me. And then there were three operations in a row, there was. My daughter went to save herself I don't know how many times putting herself in very complicated situations. And then, I had her home for [1-5] years and a half. She had a burnout and. And there you go, I had. And after then, since I had blocked, I could not reopen a lot. Actually now it's coming back these days, it's not a lot, but it's coming back in a different pattern. I don't know how. I don't know if you know the pattern system of. We seek what we have experienced, what we know as sensation. And. And so, I liked abandoning myself in the other's desire because finally, abuse is that. And then. And then indeed, in the adult to adult relationship let's say the fact that the other desires me to the point of crying, endangering themselves reassured me a lot because we find exactly the same thing finally. And then in a so-called healthy relationship, actually I have much more difficulty. So it takes more time.

Speaker 1: [02:50:29] Where is your place?

Speaker 2: [02:50:30] Yes, that's finding my place. And then there are things that change, but it's inside, so we don't know how it works, but. It's like I managed to start. I had already started with [Name], my ex, the last one just before [Partner's Name], who is in a healthy love actually. He is squarely in an artistic love. There are mirrors everywhere. It's borderline, he would take pictures all the time but. Whereas I liked the profile of men who were rather obsessed or sex addicts actually. Because actually, since I'm a bit empathic, then, I felt the other's desire that became my own desire. Yes, but if these people, we say they have a. Very developed hormones, that all the girls feel it and they jump on them all day. And then, if there's not that, then I don't feel desired actually. I need to feel the other's desire, but it has to be strong enough, powerful enough, palpable enough for the person to tremble and all that anyway. And then, I know it's quite excessive that most people are not like that. And. But then, it changes in me because I start to desire. Uh more in gentleness, another form of. Of desire that is born in me something more. More healthy. Maybe because there are things maybe that have been resolved, I don't know too much. Uh. And so it's a journey and. And I put it aside because I'm not a masochist, I'm not going to. I'm not going to cry or we can, for now it's not working, it's not

ideal, it's not ideal. There you go, we will have time to take care of us when we are together. Hmm. That's what I think But well.

Speaker 1: [02:52:39] You told me that right now you were not satisfied with your sex life. What is the frequency roughly of your sexual relations?

Speaker 2: [02:52:53] It's not once every [1-5] months. And plus before [Partner's Name], it was three times a day for me. So for me it was already complicated, but then. I did a. A. A thing, I closed up. And I keep explaining that we can't close or open things like that in 24 months, it's not possible and that we will have to readapt because we can't, we can't do things like that. And uh. And uh, there you go. But for me it works. She must be certainly hurt, but I am enormously. It hurt me a lot. For me, it was a kind of internal suicide.

Speaker 1: [02:53:48] Because it's something important for you.

Speaker 2: [02:53:52] It was crucial. So then, yes, it was very, very difficult actually. It's like I killed a part of myself. So. Yes.

Speaker 1: [02:54:05] I was going to say. And you did something that you wouldn't have done in other circumstances, meaning? As you said, you are something of yourself. You talked to me about the importance of accepting the other as they were. Of a change that was not always sometimes, that could be toxic. When we seek to change the other to suit us better. And yet that's something you did in this situation.

Speaker 2: [02:54:33] Yes, because then it was the idea, it was either I stay with or not. And since I already loved her, it was dead actually. And uh. And after I know that actually now it will take time actually. Time for us. Hmm.

Speaker 1: [02:54:49] [Month] You told me that before you had a sex life that was quite present since you say you had sex almost three times a day. Why do you think you had such a developed sex life?

Speaker 2: [02:55:07] Ah but it was only for. To seek to leave. Actually, the more you have sex, the more you like it. I thought so and the more you discover erogenous zones. Actually, the more you feel the more there you go, you are more in the. It's like it's like your thesis. It's like a research. It's like a goal, you see, to seek. There you go. To, yeah, that, to awaken actually. And and my other partners, actually, they had a lot of erogenous zones, so you did that and did that directly actually. So it was quite easy. Well yeah, but then yes, I wanted to reach myself too, have as many developed parts actually.

Speaker 1: [02:56:00] It was something related to you and not to the other.

Speaker 2: [02:56:04] Yes, it was related to me.

Speaker 1: [02:56:06] It was not at all for example a way to take what the other had to give or yourself to take some control too.

Speaker 2: [02:56:19] If? So there it's true that. Sincerely, I preferred to be someone passive, but I found myself always dominant. Always dominant. And it's true that there is a power story in sexuality. In relationships not just sexual by the way, in friendly relationships and in love relationships, there is a power story, There is a game, there is a power game, there is a ping pong. Which is quite interesting actually. But yes, there is something like that. There is what we call admiration, but there is a ping pong game and power. There is still a big power game where there is always. The. Something like that. To have something in front that uh, that resonates, that responds. But after it's true that yes. I admit that. It's true that sexually, I had power over the other. Yes, and I liked that a lot. Because the other is completely at your mercy actually. Uh. But then I felt skilled at something too. I felt skilled at something and. And I also needed. And I also needed the other to desire me, but really very very strongly actually. If it's not very strong and very. Then I don't feel desired at all and it's a story of. Of. Of that actually which is which is annoying. And with [Name], I had that problem too though. Because [Name] is not very expressive then. So it was more complicated actually for me. By the way, it was one of the reasons for our separation. Uh. Because. I think I need to be begged and cried over. And that is changing. But.

Speaker 1: [02:58:45] Prove to you. That they prove to you.

Speaker 2: [02:58:50] Yes, and that it becomes stronger than that, what. It's that I like feeling that there's electricity in the spine up to the skull, it doesn't work. I like passing under someone's arm and that the person there, there you go. I like that the person can't take it anymore at all actually. And that they are at the limit, at the limit. But I know it comes from the past, that. Hmm. Because it's the desire of predators and it looks like that. Hmm. And yes! It's the no, No Yes No No Yes, No, No Yes, Actually it's exactly that, actually. And I know it comes from there. Hmm. But I also know it's not. It's not necessarily a healthy desire. It's not necessarily healthy sex.

Speaker 1: [02:59:40] Yes, because what you describe to me is that there is an ambivalence in you. Compared to that.

Speaker 2: [02:59:52] Yes, actually, it affects your whole childhood, it affects your relationships with both your parents and what you experienced in your childhood. It's like it's the imprints that will shape your sexuality, your whole life actually and and your relationship with others. And everything actually. Absolutely everything is shaped like that. And then. I know it has an impact on uh, on that.

Speaker 1: [03:00:22] The ambivalence you.

Speaker 2: [03:00:25] No between what I want and what I am.

Speaker 1: [03:00:28] No, it was rather if I understood well, what you told me, it was the fact that there was both in you this need to be reassured and to be very very to be with someone who is very very demonstrative. Moreover, not only in sexuality in general. And then at the same time, there is this very strong desire in you to have a certain. Power or if it's not a desire, at least something you enjoy this power you can have.

Speaker 2: [03:00:56] But it's the same thing. But it's the same thing. And somehow, I didn't choose my partners by chance. Older. I choose a lot. Impossible loves still. So uh. I am really anyway. The most beautiful thing that could have happened to them for real. So then, it was not insignificant though. There is still. So there is an inferiority complex in me that must be enormous because then I really need, I would even take a dwarf missing an arm what. Hmm you see. And then, I realized it doesn't really work because except [Name], but otherwise it doesn't work. It caused other problems. Meaning the person thinks that even if there is no money, they will necessarily seek why I am with a man will invent billions of negative reasons because it's not realistic, it's not possible and then it was often more negative than positive actually. And then they were not good strategic choices. Well I don't know how to say. Well no, it's not because it worked once that it's the case every time. Actually no, on the contrary, the older person has much more baggage. And U and U. And then, yes, they are willing to do anything. But uh. But no, because actually, they had this question constantly Why me? Yeah, so they will find multiple reasons. They will find something shady, something. Something unhealthy inside. Yeah. If they don't have money, they will find it's for something else. Because they will seek a reason that seems realistic to them.

Speaker 1: [03:02:57] Yes, by taking someone older, more experienced, more difficult too. Potentially, in the relationship, there is an imbalance from the start. There is also this desire and this pleasure. To prove to yourself by almost bringing the person to the ground, at least bringing them.

Speaker 2: [03:03:16] Well actually, that's what always happened. Yes, that's it. And I was just on my throne saying it's not enough, it doesn't suit me, it's better. Otherwise, the door is there and that's exactly what happened. Before.

Speaker 1: [03:03:36] Ah well? What does it say about. Couple relationships, about the quality of couple relationships.

Speaker 2: [03:03:44] Well that. That doesn't give a quality of couple for the other, that's clear. Uh, Except in cases where. They are happy to be with me. But otherwise, uh no, it's still a very dominant relationship actually. Because then, they all became submissive. Actually, they were necessarily submissive to begin with. But but. But. A. But I was the one who needed to be reassured actually. To begin with and. And I needed proof. All the time, all the time, all the time. It's 20 love letters in the mailbox. If we didn't see each other for a day, it's I did. I was already very unhappy because there wasn't an airplane with a banner flying with my name. What? I was really unhappy. Really disappointed. Really sad. So actually, I. I could only love myself through the other. So I couldn't love myself at all. Otherwise I didn't need as much for sure. As much proof and had. I need to have something superior to the other. Just to be accepted, simply. It's like it was just to be able to have that.

Speaker 2: [03:05:22] I needed it, because it's certain that I have a problem with my self-confidence and my self-esteem and the way I see myself, etc. actually. And if it was that actually? Because it. It was bringing it to the ground as you say. But that's it actually. Because one of them told me I can't be a dog all the time. Actually, all the time. And me, what I seek is a

bear or a bear. It's the paws there that are gentle and all. But that's it actually what I seek somehow. But then, unconsciously, that's it what I seek. But I know it's not that. Because the other dedicates their entire life to you. And it's not that, it's the only ones who do that are managers, but they make a lot of money, they make money in return, you see. So I know it's not. It's not that. I started a work with [Name]. And I continue. Uh on that. And I know there is my personal need but that it's not rational.

Speaker 1: [03:06:33] Hmm.

Speaker 2: [03:06:34] I don't know how to say. I don't know.

Speaker 1: [03:06:37] I hear what you're saying.

Speaker 2: [03:06:39] I don't know how to explain. Yes. Actually, there is no need for the person to be on the ground to prove they love you and. And me if it's not the case, I don't feel loved so I know it's me. Uh, who has excessive needs.

Speaker 1: [03:07:01] And then also, if I understand what you're saying, there is once again an ambivalence because both you have that, you have this need, and then at the same time, this need also leads you to get bored after a while or eventually.

Speaker 2: [03:07:16] On the other hand, when it really happens to me, I don't get bored. Oh no, for me it's the ideal love. Perfect, I know, it's God, it's it's God for me. Oh no, there on the other hand no, it's. I have a lot of boys who confide in me. But no, no, no, that no. For me no, that's the opposite. Actually, it's God. I owe them everything. It's Oh yes, that's the opposite. It's. I would do anything for that person.

Speaker 1: [03:07:42] If ever that person is entirely dominated.

Speaker 2: [03:07:49] Actually. Yes because I didn't see it like that, I didn't realize that it was that finally, this domination for me, it was just. That the person really loves me? That's all actually. But then, with hindsight, I understood that it was that. Actually, I don't know how to say.

Speaker 1: [03:08:11] If I'm not mistaken, you also mentioned during the interview that it was important for you to have someone with response, with their own personality, who doesn't give in which seems potentially initially possibly incompatible with an entirely dominated relationship on your part.

Speaker 2: [03:08:34] Yes, there is actually what we have deep down, what we seek unconsciously, what we believe we need and then what we really need. Ah well. It's complicated. Actually, it's. Ah yeah?

Speaker 1: [03:08:54] Uh. I'd like you to tell me about one of the last positive interactions you had with [Partner's Name].

Speaker 2: [03:09:02] Hmm. Well. We were supposed to play a game, I would say. We play a game because I'd like to play a game and. We live. Like that. We say hey, let's play a game tonight, but it can change 20 times in the evening. One has a friend who calls them. They can be ready now finally at 10 pm. My daughter too. And then we are all there, we are all okay, well go ahead. I'm a bit available actually, it's my way of managing things and then [Partner's Name], she, she will get tired actually at 11 pm because she is an early riser and and then at once she went to bed. And I thought that. Well she didn't want to play. But she was sleeping actually, I think she was sleeping. So then I saw [Name] and he told me Yeah, I'm here mom, I'm here. The truth, it means he is available, even if then, she was sleeping exhausted. So I let her sleep. I said Well there you go, he is sleeping, he is sleeping. I feel a thing. So we talked, we watched his videos and all that which he likes and then then he left and then a friend called me.

Speaker 2: [03:10:36] So I talked for [1-5] hours, I said well, I'm available, then nobody needs me. Well, I talked and then and then [Partner's Name] got up and came to smoke a cigarette since I was talking and then she went back and since I can't quite. It's the first time it happens to me besides to understand what she wants and what she doesn't want, what is there and. And then, well after I cut short, I said well listen [Name], I'm going to bed and all and I went to join her and. And then she was disappointed because she told me yes, you knew it was important to me, Why didn't we go? She also wanted to go to the fireworks and the day I said I don't know because it wasn't clear. Hmm, it can change, it can change for me. I mean, you can be tired and then hop, it doesn't matter that. Tomorrow what? You have the right to be tired, You come back, you say well then, let's go, I say okay, let's go. Uh if you're tired, I can be tired at any time, then I go to bed and everyone doesn't care. And tomorrow we will do that tomorrow. And we are like that, relaxed.

Speaker 2: [03:11:40] Actually, we're pretty chill, we try to respect each other's pace. I say it's more like a roommate situation at my place. And then she tells me, "Yeah, but I made sure everything was ready for you," and I'm like, "Well, that's great, it'll be ready for tomorrow," you know? And that really hurt her. It upset her a lot because she said, "I would have thought you'd want to do something to please me." And so, she thought, "You might as well stay and play with Thibaut; you don't want to play with me?" So, in my interpretation, she told me, "I'll just go home then because you don't need me, you can stay with your son." [Name], she's sleeping. Thibault is okay with us. I mean, it's fine. If you're here, that's great; if my daughter is here, it's even better. So, I explained that it wasn't that I didn't understand, I really didn't get it, and I'm sorry. I have such a hard time understanding her ways of doing things, and that stresses me out a lot more, making me less attentive and receptive. I'm so afraid of disappointing her because I don't get how she works. So, I explained that I'm always scared of disappointing her because she easily gets upset over things that have never been an issue for me before. It's complicated for me, and I'm always afraid she'll tell me she's disappointed or that she wanted me to do something different. I don't really know what she wants, so I'm always scared. But eventually, it calmed down. I told her that if she wanted us to go somewhere, she should let me know when. So today she said she would check and let me know when we'll do something.

Speaker 1: [03:14:30] If I understand correctly, what you're describing is a negative interaction you had with [Partner's Name].

Speaker 2: [03:14:35] Ah yes, damn! No, because in the end, she told me that...

Speaker 1: [03:14:43] So, would you say that this is something you experienced as positive?

Speaker 2: [03:14:49] Well yeah, because she finally understood that I couldn't function the way she wanted me to, and it wasn't my fault. It's not that I don't care, it's that I just don't understand. I can't do it, even if I want to. It just doesn't work for me.

Speaker 1: [03:15:15] So, if you just described a positive interaction, could you then describe a negative interaction you had with [Partner's Name]?

Speaker 2: [03:15:53] She's very liberal, and when she focuses on her own needs, she forgets that I might have needs too. When I go to her place, I sleep a lot because I run twice as hard to get everything done before I leave. And then she says, "When you come, don't you want to spend time with me?" Because when I'm at her place, I sleep a lot, but it's not obvious to anyone else. So, I tell her that I'm exhausted because I run around to get everything done, making sure nothing is missing. It's extremely stressful for me. I talk to my kids all week, sending them texts, making sure everything is okay. I'm tired because I run around and stress myself out to get there. Packing bags, changing things quickly, always worrying. I feel like I'm being torn away from my nest.

Speaker 2: [03:18:41] It's very painful for me to be torn away from my nest. It's not the ideal conditions. It's not romantic at all. For me, my nest is super important. And she can't normally come here either, but even though she has leg pain, it's still painful for me to go there. It's like tearing half my body away because my place is with my kids when they're there. Because your partner can be there your whole life, but your kids won't be there for long. I want them to feel that I love them, that they can count on me, that what happens in their lives matters to me. It's important that I support them, that they know they can always call me if they have a problem. I want them to grow up with that trust. So, I'm exhausted. I actually rest when I'm there.

Speaker 1: [03:20:15] I'd like you to tell me about the challenges you face in your relationship.

Speaker 2: [03:20:31] We've overcome many challenges. At first, I could only drive for ten minutes, now I can do an hour round trip. I know the [Location] circuit by heart. I've had to do many things that I was afraid to do. I do the shopping alone now, ask [Name] for help, get things done quickly and efficiently to leave and return. At first, I said to [Partner's Name] that distance wasn't a problem, but she was right; it's a big problem. We lose things, we have bags everywhere. We're not settled in one place or the other. We can't build a routine, a normal life. We can't resolve problems efficiently and have time for pleasant things. We're exhausted.

Speaker 1: [03:23:50] You mentioned conflicts in relationships. Could you tell me about the disputes or conflicts you have with your partner?

Speaker 2: [03:24:12] The disputes are mainly about intimacy and feeling needed. She needs a lot of reassurance, and I'm often in warrior mode, which isn't reassuring. We both have small budgets, which is difficult. Co-habitation could be interesting because it's cheaper, but we've

both gone into debt trying to maintain the relationship. We've made sacrifices. [Partner's Name] has had to let go of unhealthy friendships. There's a lot of grief and complex things we've dealt with.

Speaker 1: [03:27:17] How often do these disputes occur, say, in a [1-5]-week period?

Speaker 2: [03:27:34] Not every two or three days, but there are misunderstandings. Sometimes, I think there's a problem when there isn't one. [Partner's Name] can look the same when she's in pain or upset, which confuses me. I often take things personally.

Speaker 1: [03:28:56] How do you resolve these conflicts?

Speaker 2: [03:29:00] By talking. I often misinterpret her needs, which causes issues. We try to understand each other's rhythms, but it takes time.

Speaker 1: [03:30:45] What could make you leave your partner?

Speaker 2: [03:30:57] I would only know once we live together. If she imposes things in the house, it could be a problem, but I wouldn't leave her; I would just stay in the house. Respecting each other's rhythm is crucial.

Speaker 1: [03:31:47] Would you say this relationship is good for you?

Speaker 2: [03:31:51] I think it's constructive because I learn a lot about myself. It forces me to explain things clearly and to grow. I complain less and have learned to work on my reactions and phobias.

Speaker 1: [03:33:31] Does this relationship make you feel safe?

Speaker 2: [03:33:35] I feel secure because I know we can count on each other, but I don't always feel reassured because she doesn't comfort me verbally or physically. However, she's reliable and always there for me.

Speaker 1: [03:35:18] Could you describe how the relationship has changed you and your partner?

Speaker 2: [03:35:38] I've changed a lot. I used to be more afraid and less confident. [Partner's Name] has also changed, not just because of me but because of everything she's gone through. We've both grown and overcome fears together.

Speaker 1: [03:38:04] Do you feel the same as before this relationship, or have you changed significantly?

Speaker 2: [03:38:20] I've changed a lot. I thought I had evolved, but I've realized there was still a lot to learn. [Partner's Name] has helped me see my issues more clearly and forced me to confront them.

Speaker 1: [03:39:27] Do you think [Partner's Name] has also changed during the relationship?

Speaker 2: [03:39:30] Yes, she's changed a lot because of everything she's experienced, including our relationship. She's learned to trust me and overcome her fears.

Speaker 1: [03:44:53] Do you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker 2: [03:45:05] I feel secure because I know we're committed to each other, but I don't always feel reassured because she doesn't express comfort in ways that are meaningful to me.

Speaker 1: [03:46:54] Feeling safe can also mean being able to open up to your partner without fear of judgment or reprisal. Do you feel you can do that?

Speaker 2: [03:47:07] Yes, we talk a lot and know each other's lives well. Sometimes, I don't express things well, which can be hurtful, but we try to understand each other.

Speaker 1: [03:48:47] Do you feel you receive comfort or attention from her when you need it?

Speaker 2: [03:48:54] Not physically, but she's always there to find solutions and take action when I need it. She shows her care through actions rather than words.

Speaker 1: [03:51:18] At the beginning of the interview, you mentioned having Asperger's and ADHD. Could you tell me how that affects your relationship?

Speaker 2: [03:51:44] If you live in a world where everyone respects each other's needs, there's no problem. But in a couple, it's different. I do one thing at a time, and interruptions are challenging. I need to visualize and condition myself for tasks. I don't feel the need to talk all the time. I like being alone and need time to think. It's complicated for my partner because I don't always need to do things together. We wait until the other is available, which can be hard for people who expect constant interaction.

Speaker 1: [03:56:48] Are these challenges specific to romantic relationships, or do they apply to all interpersonal relationships?

Speaker 2: [03:57:19] The difference is that romantic relationships involve expectations and interpretations, which complicate things. With friends, there's distance and less pressure.

Speaker 1: [03:58:03] I'll show you a scale and ask you to respond to two items. Can you see it?

Speaker 2: [03:58:26] Sure, go ahead.

Speaker 1: [03:58:33] In general, my partner really listens to me. On a scale from 1 to 9, where would you place yourself?

Speaker 2: [03:58:52] It's complicated because I think she really tries to listen, but understanding is different. I'd give it a seven.

Speaker 1: [04:00:14] My partner is generally responsive to my needs. Where would you place yourself on the same scale?

Speaker 2: [04:00:52] I'd say moderately true. Her own stress can make her less responsive to my needs. It depends on the moment. I'd say moderately true.

Speaker 1: [04:02:42] How satisfied are you with your relationship overall? Completely dissatisfied, very dissatisfied, somewhat dissatisfied, uncertain, neutral, somewhat satisfied, very satisfied, or completely satisfied?

Speaker 2: [04:02:59] Somewhat satisfied. We've achieved a lot, but we need to live together to see how things really are.

Speaker 1: [04:03:38] On a numerical scale from -10 to 10, where zero is neutral, where would you place your satisfaction?

Speaker 2: [04:03:49] Between six and seven.

Speaker 1: [04:03:52] Why six or seven?

Speaker 2: [04:04:09] Because we can't fully realize our potential together due to our current living situation. We need stability.

Speaker 1: [04:04:41] On a scale from -10 to 0, where would you place your dissatisfaction?

Speaker 2: [04:05:09] Between -4 and -3, depending on my mood.

Speaker 1: [04:05:41] Finally, on a scale from 0 to 10, where zero is not at all satisfied and ten is completely satisfied, where would you place yourself?

Speaker 2: [04:05:56] Six or seven, like I said before.

Speaker 1: [04:06:16] Do you have anything to add, correct, or specify?

Speaker 2: [04:06:31] The most important thing is to see how people act under pressure. Living together reveals a lot. It's crucial to see how we negotiate and find a balance. That's what determines if a relationship will work.